Michel Lieben (@MichLieben) — Complete X Account Audit

Window 2026-04-26 → 2026-10-22 (180 days; 90-day figures marked) · public data only · algorithm repository xai-org/x-algorithm@07d159b

The short version

Plain-English summary. Every number comes from the detailed sections that follow. "Typical post" means the middle post (half got more views, half fewer); "usual" means what the account was getting in the weeks just before.

Where the account stands

- A typical post gets 5,274 views (half of posts get more, half get fewer), based on 301 posts over 180 days.
- 13,338 followers; about 12 posts a week.
- Best post in the period: 556,267 views (20 Jul 2026).
- 25% of posts did more than twice the account's usual; 28% did less than half.
- Reach over the period: falling about 17% a month.
- Compared with similar accounts over the last 90 days — replies per 1,000 views: 1.0 (similar accounts: 1.8); reactions of any kind per 1,000 views: 16.5 (similar accounts: 16.7); views per 1,000 followers: 306.7 (similar accounts: 220.7); posts per week: 12.1 (similar accounts: 7.6).

What's working

X Articles
A typical one gets 7,538 views vs 3,954 for the account's other posts — about 1.9 times as many views. Based on 105 posts · Pattern in your data (not proof of cause)

> X Article: How to run paid ads from Claude Code [mega guide] — **286,424 views** · 29 Jun 2026

> X Article: The Complete Cold Email Playbook for 2026 (It's a Distribution Game Now) — **81,672 views** · 31 Jul 2026

Posts written as promotion
A typical one gets 16,748 views vs 3,590 for the account's other posts — about 4.7 times as many views (comparing posts other than X Articles). Based on 17 posts · Pattern in your data (not proof of cause)

> this should not be free https://t.co/CkzVz3Lh6d — **556,267 views** · 20 Jul 2026

> We built 12 Claude Code skills that run $300K/mo in ads across Google, Meta, and LinkedIn. I'm giving all 12 away, free. 4X ROAS on $1M+ spent. Ivan, our head o — **117,201 views** · 10 Jun 2026

Posts with educational value 1 out of 3
A typical one gets 9,420 views vs 3,590 for the account's other posts — about 2.6 times as many views (comparing posts other than X Articles). Based on 31 posts · Pattern in your data (not proof of cause)

> how to automate linkedin outreach with claude code: https://t.co/MxsSIRM3DT — **54,541 views** · 28 Apr 2026

> I'm exiting my $7M ARR agency to make the riskiest bet of my life. I'm launching a unified API that lets any team run their entire GTM from inside Claude Code. — **35,856 views** · 07 Jul 2026

What's not working

Short posts
A typical one gets 996 views vs 5,457 for the account's other posts — only about 18% as many views. Based on 10 posts · Pattern in your data (not proof of cause)

> Here's the right way to copy a viral format on LinkedIn for your own account. https://t.co/GN6fpk4RbR — **455 views** · 27 Aug 2026

> You're always told not to spray and pray in outbound. From tomorrow, you finally can... and it'll actually work. We're going live on Product Hunt with something — **653 views** · 19 Oct 2026

Long posts
A typical one gets 2,986 views vs 5,609 for the account's other posts — only about 53% as many views. Based on 45 posts · Pattern in your data (not proof of cause)

> Insane YouTube alpha here Step 1) He gave an AI agent the creators who lead his category to watch every week: Alex Finn, Nate Herk and Matthew Berman. It breaks — **806 views** · 07 Oct 2026

> Stop and pay attention to this. The CEO of a bootstrapped $50M ARR outreach tool explained how he spots a buyer before they buy: > A company just did the same t — **822 views** · 14 Oct 2026

Why reach isn't coming

1. The format you post in matters most We're fairly sure

What we see	A typical X Article post gets 7,538 views; a typical other post gets 3,954 — about 1.9 times as many views (based on 105 Articles). Weakest formats: long posts get 2,986 views typically; short posts get 996 views typically. (Pattern in your data (not proof of cause))
What X's algorithm does	For every viewer, X's ranking predicts how likely they are to like, reply, share, follow or spend time on a post, and adds those predictions up with fixed weights. Sharing a post by copying its link counts 20, a reply 5, a quote 5, following the author 4, a like 0.66. There is no special boost for X Articles in the published code; formats that earn the heavily weighted actions (shares, replies, time spent reading) rank higher. (Proven in X's published code: B05, B06, B01)
What to do	Make X Articles the main format, each with a strong native post introducing it. Turn short standalone posts into Article teasers or replies.
How we'll know it worked	Article posts keep their lead over other formats while posting volume stays the same.

2. Reach is drifting down We're somewhat sure

What we see	Reach is falling about 17% a month. A typical post got 5,663 views in April 2026 and 2,924 in October 2026. (Pattern in your data (not proof of cause))
What X's algorithm does	Retrieval follows each viewer's recent engagement. If fewer people engaged with the account recently, fewer viewers carry it in their history, so fewer are shown new posts. (Proven in X's published code: A04, A05, A12)
What to do	Track each format's typical views week by week, so a change in the mix of formats isn't mistaken for falling reach. Look again after 4 weeks of daily tracking.
How we'll know it worked	Typical weekly views for each format stop falling for 4 weeks in a row.

3. Posts get seen but not answered We're somewhat sure

What we see	For every 1,000 people who see a post, it gets about 0.98 replies; similar accounts get 1.81; 5.71 likes vs 9.86; 8.76 bookmarks vs 2.76. (Pattern in your data (not proof of cause))
What X's algorithm does	A predicted reply counts 5 — about 7.6 times a like (0.66). When the viewer and the author follow each other, a reply on an original post counts 15 more on top. So a post that people are likely to reply to is ranked higher for the next viewers; a post that gets read but not answered is not. (Proven in X's published code: B03, B08, B15)
What to do	End posts with a specific question people can answer, tied to the post's point, and reply to the first commenters within an hour to keep the conversation going.
How we'll know it worked	Replies per 1,000 views move toward what similar accounts get.

4. Comments are thin and go to the same few people We're somewhat sure

What we see	88 comments on other people's posts in the period. A typical comment is seen by about 58 people. 33% add real substance; 39% are generic, repetitive or jokes. 49% of comments go to the same 5 accounts. (Seen in your data)
What X's algorithm does	Posts from accounts a viewer doesn't follow are scored at 0.75× in For You, and replies from accounts the viewer doesn't follow are mostly filtered out of For You. So a comment is seen mainly by people reading that thread: its reach comes from the post it sits under. (Proven in X's published code: D04, D10, B15)
What to do	Swap generic 'great post' comments for 2–3 sentences of real expertise on bigger accounts in the niche, within the first hour of their post. Keep friendly comments, drop emoji-only ones.
How we'll know it worked	Most comments add real substance, and a typical comment is seen by more people than now.

5. Too many posts on the same day We're somewhat sure

What we see	The first post of a day does 0.9× the account's usual; the third or later post that day does 0.6× (based on 52 posts). (Pattern in your data (not proof of cause))
What X's algorithm does	When several posts from the same author compete in one viewer's feed, X scores the first at 1×, the second at 0.625×, the third at 0.438× and later ones down towards 0.25× (author diversity). Several posts in a short time compete with each other for the same viewers. (Proven in X's published code: D09, B12, B13)
What to do	Post at most 2 times a day, at least 6 hours apart. Put extra ideas in replies, threads or the next day.
How we'll know it worked	No more days with 3+ posts, with total weekly views not falling.

What to do next, in order

1. **Make X Articles the main format, each with a strong native post introducing it. Turn short standalone posts into Article teasers or replies.**
   Why: For every viewer, X's ranking predicts how likely they are to like, reply, share, follow or spend time on a post, and adds those predictions up with fixed weights. · Check: Article posts keep their lead over other formats while posting volume stays the same.
2. **Track each format's typical views week by week, so a change in the mix of formats isn't mistaken for falling reach. Look again after 4 weeks of daily tracking.**
   Why: Retrieval follows each viewer's recent engagement. · Check: Typical weekly views for each format stop falling for 4 weeks in a row.
3. **End posts with a specific question people can answer, tied to the post's point, and reply to the first commenters within an hour to keep the conversation going.**
   Why: A predicted reply counts 5 — about 7.6 times a like (0.66). · Check: Replies per 1,000 views move toward what similar accounts get.
4. **Swap generic 'great post' comments for 2–3 sentences of real expertise on bigger accounts in the niche, within the first hour of their post. Keep friendly comments, drop emoji-only ones.**
   Why: Posts from accounts a viewer doesn't follow are scored at 0.75× in For You, and replies from accounts the viewer doesn't follow are mostly filtered out of For You. · Check: Most comments add real substance, and a typical comment is seen by more people than now.
5. **Post at most 2 times a day, at least 6 hours apart. Put extra ideas in replies, threads or the next day.**
   Why: When several posts from the same author compete in one viewer's feed, X scores the first at 1×, the second at 0.625×, the third at 0.438× and later ones down towards 0.25× (author diversity). · Check: No more days with 3+ posts, with total weekly views not falling.

> At about 12 posts a week, a 30-day test can only prove a change of about 2.3× or more in typical views. Smaller improvements will show a direction, not proof — keep testing.

Words used in this report

Typical post	The middle post: half of the posts got more views, half got fewer. One viral post can't distort it the way an average can.
Usual	What the account's posts were getting in the weeks just before. A post at 2× usual did twice as well as the account normally does at that time.
Proven in X's published code	We read it in the source code xAI published (file and line cited). The published code is not guaranteed to be everything X runs.
Seen in your data	Counted directly from the account's public posts.
Pattern in your data (not proof of cause)	Posts with this feature did better or worse, but other things may explain it.
Idea to test	A reasoned suggestion that the data can't confirm yet.

Details for analysts

The full evidence behind the short version: statistics, confidence intervals, every diagnostic and its citations into X's published code.

> How to read this report: every finding carries an evidence class — repo verified · account observed · statistical association · hypothesis · unsupported · insufficient. Associations are not causes; the published repository does not describe every live production system; no metric here is an X algorithm score.

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1. Executive summary

FOLLOWERS
13,338
snapshot 2026-10-23

TYPICAL VIEWS PER POST (MEDIAN)
5,274
n=301 · 180d

TREND PER 30 DAYS
0.83x
90% CI 0.78–0.88

TYPICAL VIEWS PER COMMENT (MEDIAN)
58
n=88 conversational

Top 5 potential barriers to organic growth

#	Issue	Status	Confidence	Evidence class	Priority
1	Content format drives most of the reach difference	supported	high	statistical association	0.89
2	Reach trend over the window	supported	medium	statistical association	0.74
3	Low conversation generation per impression	supported	medium	statistical association	0.68
4	Commenting is low-depth and concentrated on a small circle	supported	medium	account observed	0.64
5	Several authored posts on the same day	supported	medium	statistical association	0.62

Priority = 0.30·evidence strength + 0.25·likely impact + 0.20·business relevance + 0.15·confidence + 0.10·ease of testing (transparent internal weighting).

Stop / continue / start

Stop

- Reduce: Content format: short_post (0.18x median, n=10)
- Reduce: Content format: long_post (0.53x median, n=45)
- Stop publishing a 3rd authored post on the same day
- Stop generic/emoji-only comments; they earn little exposure
- Stop mass identical public 'Sent' replies (test DM/pinned delivery)

Continue

- Keep: Content format: x_article (1.91x median, n=105)
- Keep: Narrative structure: promotion (4.67x median, n=17) (excluding X Articles)
- Keep: Educational value (0-3): 1.0 (2.62x median, n=31) (excluding X Articles)

Start

- Start measuring: daily metric snapshots + follower history (monitoring)
- Start the randomised hook and closing-prompt tests (see 30-day plan)
- Start substantive comments on larger in-niche accounts within their first hour
- Start replying to early commenters within 60 minutes to build conversation depth

2. Data completeness and confidence

Data	Status	Detail
Posts, replies, quotes, reposts (180 days)	available	1583 records from the ThoughtPilot console store
Views (public view count)	available	1570 of 1583 records have views
Likes, replies, reposts, quotes, bookmarks	available	public counts
Metric scrape time	partial	the store does not record when metrics were scraped; observations are stamped at import time. Spot-check vs an August scrape: stored views were equal or higher for overlapping posts (metrics are refreshed, not frozen).
Engagement over time per post	unavailable	one observation per post; monitoring (Phase 2) builds the time series
Follower count	partial	single snapshot on 2026-10-23; no historical follower growth
Profile bio / account creation date	unavailable	user-info returned no description or creation date
Media type (image/video)	unavailable	not in source records; t.co URLs may be links or media
Profile visits, follows, link clicks, audience demographics	unavailable	private analytics; this audit uses public data only (by decision)
Reply parent author	inferred	from leading @mention for 1201 replies; confirmed by tweet-detail for 34
Reply parent post (time, text, engagement)	sample	tweet-detail collected for 71 replies across clients (most recent conversational comments); 95 conversational comments in total for this account
Who engaged with the account's posts	available	780 public replies/quotes by others (client-engagers); likes are not exposed
Content/reply labels	available	label methods: {'llm:claude-sonnet-session-review': 1545, 'none': 38}
Immature posts (<72h old at observation)	excluded from baselines	17 posts

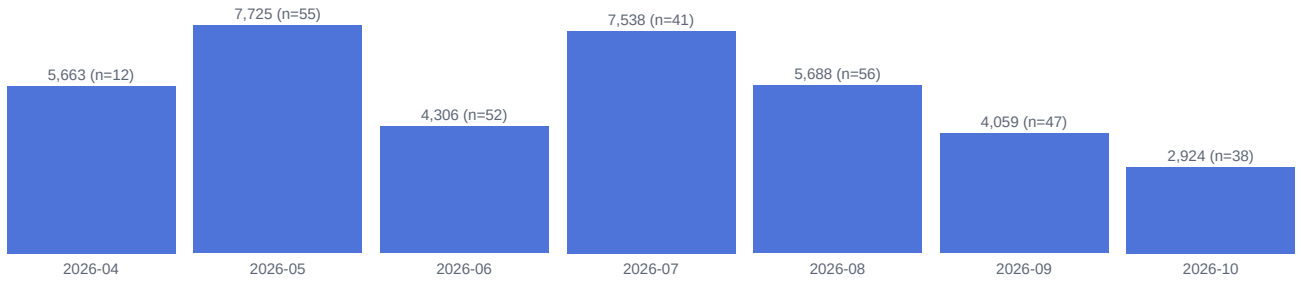
3. Historical performance

Reach by post type (mature posts, 180 days)

Segment	n	Typical (median)	p25	p75	p90	Mean	Median / follower
authored (original + quote)	301	5,274	2,735	11,680	26,316	14,219	39.54%
original	170	5,508	2,626	13,493	28,114	13,007	41.30%
quote	131	4,870	2,846	10,918	21,755	15,793	36.51%
reply to others	1222	10	5	25	54	26	0.07%
self-reply (thread)	24	367	236	627	1,177	848	2.75%

90-day window: median authored views 4,091 (n=147). The top 5% of authored posts produced 47% of authored views (top single post 13%), so medians, not totals, describe a typical post. Relative to each post's trailing 28-day baseline: 25% exceeded 2x, 28% fell below 0.5x.

Monthly median views (authored) and posting volume



Month	Authored posts	Typical views (median)	Total views	Replies to others	Median reply views
2026-04	12	5,663	200,783	88	20
2026-05	55	7,725	745,308	35	6
2026-06	52	4,306	1,158,160	239	7
2026-07	41	7,538	1,149,151	113	21
2026-08	56	5,688	519,245	417	13
2026-09	47	4,059	342,563	322	7
2026-10	38	2,924	164,732	14	29

Engagement efficiency (per 1,000 views; observed outcomes, not ranking scores)

Type	likes /1k (median)	replies /1k (median)	reposts /1k (median)	quotes /1k (median)	bookmarks /1k (median)	eng /1k (median)
authored	4.96	0.47	0.36	0.00	8.76	15.21
reply to others	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00

Unavailable: profile visits per 1k (private analytics (account owner export) — not collected); follows per 1k (private analytics — not collected); link clicks per 1k (private analytics — not collected); video watch metrics (private analytics; media type also not present in source data); dwell time (not exposed publicly at all).

4. Posting audit

Characteristics associated with higher or lower reach

Each level vs all other authored posts. Ratio of medians with 90% bootstrap CI; q = Benjamini–Hochberg adjusted p across 82 comparisons. Only q < 0.1 shown as signals. Associations only.

Feature	Level	n	Typical views (median)	Ratio	90% CI	q	Signal
Content format	long_post	45	2,986	0.53x	0.35–0.76	0.009	lower
Content format	short_post	10	996	0.18x	0.13–0.32	0.004	lower
Content format	x_article	105	7,538	1.91x	1.55–2.62	0.000	higher
Topic	LinkedIn & social selling	46	7,184	1.40x	1.00–2.25	0.043	higher
Opening hook type	contrarian	29	3,715	0.67x	0.42–0.84	0.021	lower
Opening hook type	how_to	101	7,049	1.70x	1.29–2.34	0.007	higher
Narrative structure	promotion	18	14,006	2.68x	1.40–5.24	0.008	higher
Narrative structure	tutorial	113	5,937	1.36x	1.05–1.77	0.093	higher
Length	very long (400+)	37	2,558	0.46x	0.39–0.64	0.008	lower
Length	very short (<15 words)	130	7,540	1.95x	1.65–2.58	0.000	higher
Contains t.co URL (link or media)	False	115	3,726	0.56x	0.46–0.71	0.004	lower
Contains t.co URL (link or media)	True	186	6,616	1.78x	1.42–2.14	0.004	higher
List formatting	False	220	5,994	1.67x	1.35–2.16	0.008	higher
List formatting	True	81	3,590	0.60x	0.46–0.74	0.008	lower
Contains numbers/data	False	179	6,281	1.55x	1.19–1.92	0.012	higher
Contains numbers/data	True	122	4,045	0.64x	0.52–0.83	0.012	lower
Opinion strength (0-3)	0.0	191	5,882	1.51x	1.05–1.89	0.033	higher
Educational value (0-3)	0.0	43	3,262	0.59x	0.46–0.76	0.092	lower
Educational value (0-3)	2.0	138	6,580	1.68x	1.19–2.00	0.008	higher
Educational value (0-3)	3.0	85	3,765	0.65x	0.49–0.84	0.012	lower

Multivariable model (controls: month fixed effects; HC3 robust errors)

log_views ~ C(format) + C(month) + C(topic) + tco_url_excl_articles + has_list + uses_data + personal_experience + promotional + keyword_cta + log_words · n=301 · R^2 0.27. Multipliers are relative to the reference level of each factor.

Term	Multiplier	90% CI	p
log_words	0.78x	0.65–0.94	0.028
personal_experience	1.38x	1.08–1.76	0.029
C(format)[T.short_post]	0.34x	0.15–0.77	0.029
promotional	1.77x	1.08–2.92	0.059
C(format)[T.quote_post]	1.38x	0.98–1.95	0.118
C(topic)[T.data enrichment & Clay]	0.68x	0.45–1.03	0.127
C(topic)[T.buying signals & intent data]	0.72x	0.47–1.09	0.187
C(topic)[T.outbound & cold email]	0.80x	0.61–1.06	0.188
keyword_cta	1.24x	0.83–1.86	0.374
C(topic)[T.agency business & scaling]	0.83x	0.51–1.33	0.511
uses_data	1.09x	0.87–1.38	0.528
C(topic)[T.content & personal brand]	0.82x	0.48–1.39	0.531
tco_url_excl_articles	0.85x	0.55–1.31	0.538
C(topic)[T.LinkedIn & social selling]	1.10x	0.80–1.51	0.628

Time and frequency

12.0 authored posts and 48.0 replies per week; active on 83% of days; up to 146 replies in a single day.

Same-day order	n	Median vs baseline
1st post of the day	141	0.94x
2nd post of the day	103	0.99x
3rd+ post of the day	52	0.60x

Gap since previous post	n	Median vs baseline
<2h	24	1.18x
2-6h	96	0.71x
6-24h	139	0.95x
>24h	36	0.89x

Reply volume vs authored reach (Spearman): same day ρ=0.01 (p=0.831); previous 3 days ρ=0.08 (p=0.177).

5. Commenting audit

Reply roles: fulfilment 1140 · conversation 95 · self thread 26. Fulfilment replies are inferred from their template text. Each one answers a person who commented a keyword, so their volume is a lower bound on keyword-CTA comments received.

Category	n	Typical views (median)	Median likes	Share with a reply	Median effectiveness
relationship building	17	216	1.0	41%	23.5
original insight	15	33	1.0	33%	63.9
low value repetitive	13	59	0.0	15%	10.5
generic agreement	12	52	1.0	33%	29.4
humor	9	76	1.0	44%	34.2
expert explanation	8	60	1.0	25%	66.9
promotional	8	42	0.0	12%	35.0
personal experience	4	110	2.0	25%	74.1
constructive disagreement	1	73	0.0	100%	86.3
question	1	54	1.0	0%	66.1

Commenting Effectiveness Score — internal diagnostic, not an X algorithm score. Weights: relevance 0.25, originality 0.25, observed_engagement 0.2, conversation 0.15, timing 0.15 (timing unavailable → redistributed).

Thread-context sample (n=27): median delay after the parent post 144 min; 22% within the first hour; parent author replied to 26%.

Commenting questions

Are the accounts commenting on relevant posts?
51% of conversational comments are on ICP-relevant subjects (judged from reply text; parent post unavailable). account_observed

Are replies early enough to participate in active discussions?
In a sample of 27 recent comments with thread context, the median delay after the parent post was 144 minutes; 22% were within the first hour. account_observed

Do parent authors respond?
26% of sampled comments got a visible reply from the parent author. account_observed

Are comments substantive or repetitive?
33% substantive (insight, expertise, question, disagreement, experience); see category mix. account_observed

Are replies attracting new people or the same small group?
47 distinct accounts commented on; the top 5 receive 49% of comments. Who engages *with* the comments is not observable without engager collection. account_observed

Is reply activity associated with follower growth?
Insufficient data: no follower-count history exists yet (monitoring will create it). insufficient

Typical exposure per comment
median 58 views per conversational comment (n=88). account_observed

Most-viewed comments

Date	To	Comment	Category	Views
2026-07-01	@itsalexvacca	@itsalexvacca 3 years in and you're just getting started. So proud of you Alex. Let's go💪	relationship building	513
2026-06-05	@itsalexvacca	@itsalexvacca another banger.	generic agreement	434
2026-07-07	@adam_ferg6	@adam_ferg6 100%	generic agreement	355
2026-07-07	@ArnaudBelingaCX	@ArnaudBelingaCX Let’s chat Arnaud 😎	relationship building	348
2026-07-07	@Neuronirav	@Neuronirav cool, will check it out.	relationship building	343
2026-08-02	@berner_my	@berner_my that was a typo.. their subject line was the prospects' phone number.	personal experience	337
2026-07-07	@Tycho_luijten	@Tycho_luijten haha, thanks man 🙌	relationship building	322
2026-07-27	@akzebrowski	@akzebrowski distribution has always been the moat. AI has just forced people to accept that reality.	original insight	300

6. Audience and network

47 distinct accounts received conversational comments; the top 5 received 49% (HHI 0.062); 6 accounts received 3+ comments.

Account commented on	Comments	Typical views (median)	Total views	Share with a reply	Peer/client
@nifinet	14	54	1,320	29%	yes
@Tycho_luijten	10	166	1,535	60%	
@nikolak47	9	58	723	33%	
@itsalexvacca	6	228	1,625	50%	yes
@triolojules	4	42	164	25%	
@VukConfidential	3	22	66	0%	
@LoicReco	2	54	109	0%	
@Panoptimos	1	46	46	0%	
@MysticEru	1	59	59	0%	
@MaksimXBT	1	31	31	0%	
@mod_ranger	1	80	80	0%	
@MichaelSaruggia	1	209	209	0%	
@adam_ferg6	1	355	355	0%	
@Kellen_the_man	1	220	220	100%	
@Neuronirav	1	343	343	0%	

780 public replies/quotes from 639 distinct accounts (2026-07-26 → 2026-10-21); 92% engaged only once; the top 10 accounts made 12% of engagements; 30 engagers are also accounts @MichLieben comments on (12% of engagements). Public replies/quotes that mention the account (since 2026-07-25), from the console store; includes replies to the account's comments elsewhere. Likes and reposts are not exposed.

Accounts that replied to or quoted @MichLieben

Account	Replies/quotes
@nifinet	23
@Tycho_luijten	10
@nikolak47	9
@VukConfidential	9
@Vick_Mucunski	8
@NateAndorsky	8
@triolojules	6
@niyyahxai	6
@BeeReach_io	6
@MoneyCrptBunny	5
@simplydt	4
@max_bevza	4
@dg_austintx	4
@chenzhangreal	4
@Gsandec	4

> Private social-graph relationships (who follows whom, mutual follows) are not inferred from public replies.

7. Potential reach barriers — full diagnostics

Content format drives most of the reach difference statistical association · supported · confidence: high

Observation	X Article posts reach 1.91x the median views of the account's other authored posts (n=105, 90% CI 1.55-2.62). Lower formats: short_post 0.18x (n=10), long_post 0.53x (n=45).
Evidence	X Article median / other authored median: **1.91** · X Article posts: **105** · ratio CI: **1.55-2.62** · BH q-value: **0** · short_post median ratio: **0.18** · short_post posts: **10** · long_post median ratio: **0.53** · long_post posts: **45** · regression multiplier (month+topic controls): **0.8** · top X Article: 286424 views · top X Article: 81672 views · top X Article: 68900 views
Algorithm connection	The value model rewards predicted dwell, click-dwell and sharing (dwell, cont_click_dwell_time, share_via_copy_link weights). Long-form articles plausibly raise those predictions; the repo does not contain an article-specific boost. B05 · Published weights: shares (copy link 20), dwell, quote (home-mixer/params/param.rs:381-395) B06 · Published weights: follow_author, unexplored, continuous dwell (home-mixer/params/param.rs:396-437) B01 · Predicted heads consumed by the value model (xai-value-model/phoenix_scores.rs:1-31)
Alternative explanations	Article topics may simply be the account's strongest topics; X may surface Articles through surfaces outside the For You ranking studied here; Articles are often promoted harder (pinned, quoted by co-founders/peers)
Impact	Largest observed lever: shifting mix toward the best format changes the median outcome, not just outliers.
Recommendation	Make X Articles (with a strong native preview post) the anchor format, and turn short standalone posts into either article teasers or replies.
Validation	A/B over 4 weeks: alternate article vs non-article on matched topics; compare median views per format.
Success criteria	Article posts keep >= the current ratio vs other formats while posting volume is held constant.
Confounders	topic, promotion effort, author network resharing

Reach trend over the window statistical association · supported · confidence: medium

Observation	Median views on authored posts trend at 0.83x per 30 days (90% CI 0.78–0.88, n=301); monthly medians went from 5663 (2026-04) to 2924 (2026-10).
Evidence	Theil–Sen multiplicative trend per 30d: **0.83** · trend CI low: **0.78** · trend CI high: **0.88** · posts: **301** · first month median views: **5,663** · last month median views: **2,924** · implied decline % per 30d: **17**
Algorithm connection	Out-of-network retrieval is driven by viewers' recent engagement histories (Phoenix two-tower, SimClusters seeds). A sustained decline is consistent with fewer viewers having recently engaged with the account, but the repository cannot attribute it. A04 · Viewer's recent engagement sequence feeds Phoenix retrieval (home-mixer/query_hydrators/retrieval_sequence_query_hydrator.rs:36-61) A05 · Phoenix retrieval is a two-tower model over engagement history (phoenix/README.md:99-121) A12 · SimClusters seeds come from the viewer's recent engagements (home-mixer/sources/simclusters_source.rs:222-252)
Alternative explanations	Change in content mix (fewer X Articles or long tutorials in recent months); Seasonality / audience attention (summer vs autumn); Platform-wide changes in view counting or feed composition (weights changed in Sept–Oct; see parameter history); Recent posts' views still accruing despite the 72h maturity filter
Impact	Determines whether the priority is recovering lost distribution or growing from a stable base.
Recommendation	Track weekly median views for each format separately so a format-mix shift is not mistaken for a reach decline; re-run after 4 weeks of monitoring.
Validation	Format-stratified weekly medians from continuous monitoring; check the trend within X Articles only.
Success criteria	Weekly authored median views stop declining for 4 consecutive weeks (format-adjusted).
Confounders	content mix, seasonality, platform weight changes, metric maturity

Low conversation generation per impression statistical association · supported · confidence: medium

Observation	Replies per 1,000 views: 0.98 vs peer median 1.81 (0.54x). Likes per 1,000 views: 5.71 vs 9.86. Bookmarks per 1,000 views: 8.76 vs 2.76.
Evidence	client replies per 1k views: **0.98** · peer median replies per 1k views: **1.81** · client/peer replies per 1k views: **0.54** · client engagements per 1k views: **16.47** · peer median engagements per 1k views: **16.7** · client/peer engagements per 1k views: **0.99** · client bookmarks per 1k views: **8.76** · peer median bookmarks per 1k views: **2.76** · client/peer bookmarks per 1k views: **3.18** · client likes per 1k views: **5.71** · peer median likes per 1k views: **9.86** · client/peer likes per 1k views: **0.58**
Algorithm connection	Published defaults weight a viewer's predicted reply probability at 5.0 versus 0.66 for a like; for original posts from an author the viewer mutually follows, the reply weight is raised by a further 15.0. Weights multiply the model's predicted probabilities per viewer, not raw counts, so observed reply rates are only an outcome proxy for what the model predicts. B03 · Published weights: like, reply, bidirectional boost, repost (home-mixer/params/param.rs:345-359) B08 · Weights multiply predicted probabilities; only Home Timeline engagement counts (home-mixer/params/param.rs:316-344) B15 · Bidirectional boost eligibility: mutual-follow original posts only (xai-value-model/weights.rs:84-100)
Alternative explanations	Audience composition differs from peers (more lurkers / buyers who do not reply); Lead-magnet CTAs convert replies into keyword comments counted elsewhere; Peer accounts differ in size; per-view rates partly normalise this but not fully
Impact	Conversation is the most heavily weighted positive action family; raising it is the most algorithm-aligned lever available from content alone.
Recommendation	End posts with a specific, answerable prompt tied to the post's claim; reply to early commenters within the first hour to deepen threads.
Validation	Compare replies per 1k views on posts with vs without a specific closing prompt over 4 weeks.
Success criteria	Median replies per 1k views on authored posts moves toward the peer median.
Confounders	audience size, topic, CTA type

Commenting is low-depth and concentrated on a small circle account observed · supported · confidence: medium

Observation	88 conversational comments in the window; 33% are substantive and 39% are generic, repetitive or humour. The top 5 accounts receive 49% of comments; median exposure is 58.5 views per comment.
Evidence	conversational comments (mature): **88** · median views per comment: **58.5** · substantive share: **0.33** · generic/repetitive/humor share: **0.39** · share of comments to top-5 accounts: **0.49** · distinct accounts commented on: **47** · comments that drew a reply: **0.31** · relationship_building (n=17) median views: **216** · original_insight (n=15) median views: **33** · low_value_repetitive (n=13) median views: **59** · generic_agreement (n=12) median views: **51.5** · humor (n=9) median views: **76** · expert_explanation (n=8) median views: **60**
Algorithm connection	In the published For You pipeline, out-of-network replies are filtered out by default and in-network replies receive the 0.75 out-of-network-style rescore, so a comment is seen mainly inside the parent conversation, not distributed in feeds. Comments can still build mutual-follow relationships, and the reply weight is raised for original posts from mutually-followed authors. The repo has no 'comment boost' for the commenter's own posts. D04 · Out-of-network reposts and replies are filtered out (home-mixer/filters/oon_retweet_reply_filter.rs:15-28) D10 · Out-of-network discount (OonWeightFactor 0.75), also for in-network replies/reposts (xai-value-model/scoring.rs:206-251) B15 · Bidirectional boost eligibility: mutual-follow original posts only (xai-value-model/weights.rs:84-100)
Alternative explanations	Comments within a founder circle may serve partnership/relationship goals rather than reach; Parent-post context (unavailable for most replies) may make short replies more relevant than they look
Impact	Comment exposure is small per reply; quality matters more than volume for building recognition.
Recommendation	Replace generic agreement with 2-3 sentence expert additions on larger in-niche accounts' posts within their first hour; keep relationship comments but stop emoji/one-word replies.
Validation	Track median views and reply-backs per comment for 'expert addition' comments vs the current mix.
Success criteria	Substantive share > 60% and median views per comment above current median.
Confounders	parent-post reach, timing (unmeasured), relationship goals

Several authored posts on the same day statistical association · supported · confidence: medium

Observation	Third-or-later authored posts on the same day reach a median 0.6x of baseline (n=52) versus 0.94x for the first post of the day (n=141).
Evidence	1st post of day: median vs-baseline: **0.94** · n first posts: **141** · 3rd+ post of day: median vs-baseline: **0.6** · n 3rd+ posts: **52** · authored posts per week: **12** · gap <2h: median vs-baseline (n=24): **1.18** · gap 2-6h: median vs-baseline (n=96): **0.71** · gap 6-24h: median vs-baseline (n=139): **0.95** · gap >24h: median vs-baseline (n=36): **0.89**
Algorithm connection	vm-ranker applies an author-diversity multiplier within each viewer's ranked feed: a repeat author's later candidates are multiplied by (1 - floor) * decay^k + floor with AuthorDiversityDecay 0.5 and AuthorDiversityFloor 0.25. Several fresh posts compete for the same viewer slots. This is per viewer request, so it is a plausible mechanism, not a measured penalty on this account. D09 · Author diversity multiplier decays repeated authors within one feed (xai-value-model/scoring.rs:183-204) B12 · Author diversity decay and out-of-network discount (vm-ranker) (vm-ranker/params.rs:169-228) B13 · ComputeValueModel default false is overridden by the request flag (vm-ranker/scoring/mod.rs:31-35)
Alternative explanations	Later posts of the day may be lower-effort or reactive; Time-of-day differences (later posts land outside peak hours); Small sample for 3rd+ posts
Impact	Spacing posts is a free change; if the association is real, it recovers reach on the weakest third of posts.
Recommendation	Cap authored posts at 2 per day, at least 6 hours apart; move extra content into replies, threads, or the next day.
Validation	2-week alternating schedule (stacked vs spaced days) with the same formats; compare vs-baseline medians.
Success criteria	3rd+-post days disappear without lowering weekly total views.
Confounders	time of day, post quality, format

Reach depends on rare breakouts

account observed · not_supported · confidence: medium

Observation	The top 5% of authored posts produced 47% of authored views; the single top post 13%. 28% of posts land below half the trailing baseline and 25% above twice it.
Evidence	share of authored views from top 5% of posts: **0.47** · share from the single top post: **0.13** · posts below 0.5x baseline: **0.28** · posts above 2x baseline: **0.25** · top post: 556267 views · top post: 286424 views · top post: 269226 views
Algorithm connection	Out-of-network discovery starts small (cold-start pool for posts with few likes/views; retrieval-index admission triggered by likes) and only some posts escape it. Heavy-tailed outcomes are expected from this design. A07 · Cold-start retrieval pool: low-fav, low-view, fresh posts (phoenix/xrex/data/cold_pool_filter.py:16-51) A08 · Phoenix retrieval index admission is triggered by favorite events (phoenix-rankall-strato/columns/phoenix_rank_all/phoenixRankAllCandidateProcessor.strato:469-530) D19 · Cold-start lift for low-impression posts from smaller authors (home-mixer/scorers/author_cold_start.rs:188-193)
Alternative explanations	Viral posts may be driven by external resharing (large accounts, newsletters)
Impact	Averages mislead: judge experiments on medians and share-above-baseline, not totals.
Recommendation	Reverse-engineer the top posts' structure into a repeatable template; judge tests on medians.
Validation	Share of posts above 2x baseline per month.
Success criteria	Share above 2x baseline rises without lowering the median.
Confounders	external amplification

Weak openings / low-utility structures

statistical association · mixed · confidence: low

Observation	Opening/structure patterns with clear differences (X Articles set aside): Narrative structure = promotion: 4.67x (n=17); Educational value (0-3) = 1.0: 2.62x (n=31).
Evidence	Narrative structure: promotion (n=17) median ratio: **4.67** · Educational value (0-3): 1.0 (n=31) median ratio: **2.62** · opening/structure levels compared (X Articles set aside): **20**
Algorithm connection	Dwell and click-dwell predictions are weighted positively and 'not_dwelled' negatively in published defaults; an opening that earns an expand plausibly raises those predictions. B05 · Published weights: shares (copy link 20), dwell, quote (home-mixer/params/param.rs:381-395) B04 · Published weights: clicks, expands, profile click 0, VQV 0 (home-mixer/params/param.rs:360-380)
Alternative explanations	Hook type correlates with format and topic; Labels are model judgements and can be noisy
Impact	Hooks are cheap to change and testable post-by-post.
Recommendation	Lead with the concrete outcome or how-to promise; avoid opinion-only or vague observational openers.
Validation	Paired test: same topic, two hook styles on different days; compare vs-baseline ratios.
Success criteria	Hook-type gap persists in a controlled 4-week test.
Confounders	topic, format

Off-core topics underperform core topics

statistical association | not_supported | confidence: low

Observation	The top two topics account for 53% of authored posts.
Evidence	share of authored posts in top-2 topics: **0.53**
Algorithm connection	SimClusters and Phoenix retrieval match posts to viewers whose recent engagement resembles the post. Consistent topics make it more likely the right viewers already have related engagement history; the repo exposes no per-account topic score. A11 · SimClusters source constants (score floor, seed age, result caps) (home-mixer/sources/simclusters_source.rs:25-36) A12 · SimClusters seeds come from the viewer's recent engagements (home-mixer/sources/simclusters_source.rs:222-252) A05 · Phoenix retrieval is a two-tower model over engagement history (phoenix/README.md:99-121)
Alternative explanations	Topic effects overlap with format (tutorial topics are more often articles); Off-core posts may be personal/timely and judged on other goals
Impact	Concentrating on the strongest clusters improves the median post without adding volume.
Recommendation	Prioritise the higher-reach topics listed; reduce off-core posts or move them to replies.
Validation	Re-run the topic comparison after 6 weeks with the regression (format + month controls).
Success criteria	Share of authored posts in the higher-reach topics rises with no fall in their median.
Confounders	format, timing, promotion

High-volume templated replies (lead-magnet fulfilment)

hypothesis | supported | confidence: low

Observation	1140 template replies ('Sent', 'Here you go: <link>') to 1060 distinct accounts, about 44.6 per week. These are fulfilment of comment-for-resource CTAs, inferred from their template text.
Evidence	fulfilment replies: **1,140** · fulfilment replies per week: **44.6** · distinct recipients: **1,060** · keyword CTA posts: median views ratio: **0.7** · keyword CTA posts n: **37** · promotional posts: median views ratio: **0.96** · promotional posts n: **34**
Algorithm connection	A published botmaker rule clusters replies with duplicate text and applies a COPYPASTA_SPAM label (skipping high-PageRank and grey-verified users), and the Grox reply_spam flow can label risky replies. Whether these clients' identical 'Sent' replies are labelled, and what any label does to reach, is not observable and partly withheld; this is a risk to monitor, not an observed penalty. C15 · botmaker-rules label duplicate-text replies as COPYPASTA_SPAM (some rules withheld) (botmaker-rules/scarecrow/bot/BBQDuplicateTextRepliesProd.bot:25-46) C11 · Grox reply spam flags replies with RiskyHighVizReply unless high cred (>= 66) (grox/flows/reply_spam/task_write.py:39-80) C12 · Grox prompts withheld; UPA "banger" screen and multimodal embeddings (grox/flows/ptos/prompts.py:11-11)
Alternative explanations	Keyword-CTA posts generate many replies, which is itself a strong positive signal; Templated fulfilment is normal for lead magnets and widely used by peers
Impact	Mainly risk management and time cost; also inflates 'reply' counts so commenting looks larger than it is.
Recommendation	Keep lead magnets but vary fulfilment (short personalised line + resource), or deliver via one pinned reply / DM automation instead of hundreds of identical public replies.
Validation	Compare authored-post reach in weeks with vs without mass fulfilment replies (matched formats).
Success criteria	No drop in lead-magnet conversions with < 25% of current identical public replies.
Confounders	lead-magnet topic quality, CTA wording

External links reduce reach (common claim) statistical association · not_supported · confidence: low

Observation	Among non-article authored posts, posts containing a t.co URL (external link or media) reach 1.31x the median of those without (n=81 vs 115).
Evidence	non-article posts with t.co URL: ratio: **1.31** · n with URL: **81** · n without URL: **115** · CI: **0.92-1.85**
Algorithm connection	The published ranking code contains no link penalty: open_link carries a small positive weight. has_url is computed only for an experimental debias payload that is off by default. Media and external links cannot be separated in this data. B04 · Published weights: clicks, expands, profile click 0, VQV 0 (home-mixer/params/param.rs:360-380) D17 · Debias payload with has_url is sent to vm-ranker only when enabled (default off) (home-mixer/scorers/vm_ranker_request.rs:17-24)
Alternative explanations	t.co URLs include attached media, which may help; Link posts are often promotional
Impact	Determines whether link placement should change; the repository gives no reason to expect a penalty.
Recommendation	Do not restructure content around a link penalty; if testing, put the link in a self-reply on half of link posts and compare.
Validation	Randomised link-in-post vs link-in-reply on comparable posts for 4 weeks.
Success criteria	Decision rule in experiment plan.
Confounders	media vs link, promotional intent

Signs of visibility limitations insufficient · not_supported · confidence: insufficient evidence

Observation	0 of 301 mature authored posts have fewer than 100 views; reach is continuous with the account's normal range. No public signal indicates a visibility restriction; this audit cannot observe X's visibility-filtering decisions.
Evidence	mature authored posts with < 100 views: **0** · mature authored posts: **301** · median views per reply: **10** · X does not expose visibility labels or filter decisions to the public; none can be observed here
Algorithm connection	Visibility filtering (Allow/Notice/Interstitial/Drop) and account-quality systems exist in the repository, but their per-account outputs are not public. C16 · Visibility-filtering verdicts are Withheld (Drop/Tombstone) or Shown with notices (visibility-filtering/models/verdict.rs:8-26) D13 · VFFilter drops only Drop/Tombstone/NotEvaluated; Downrank/Avoid kept (home-mixer/filters/vf_filter.rs:22-27) C07 · No user-cred input in the For You value-model scoring path (xai-value-model/inputs.rs:3-17)
Alternative explanations	Any decline is better explained by format/topic mix and the trend analysis
Impact	No action warranted on current evidence; claims of suppression would be speculation.
Recommendation	Do not act on shadowban theories; monitor for abrupt step-changes (>50% week-on-week drop across all formats) as the trigger to investigate.
Validation	Monitoring alert on control limits (rolling median ± 3 MAD) across formats.
Success criteria	No unexplained cross-format step change.

8. Algorithm connections

Findings from the published repository referenced in this audit (status: verified = read in code; inferred = reasoned from code). Repository code is not a complete description of live production systems; published parameter defaults are cron-synced but experiments may override them.

ID	Finding	Location	Status
A04	**Viewer's recent engagement sequence feeds Phoenix retrieval** RetrievalSequenceQueryHydrator fetches the viewer's aggregated user-action sequence from the user action aggregation service, with length up to MaxSeqLengthRetrieval (default 1024) and aggregation type PhoenixRetrievalAggregationType (default DENSE_WITH_LONG_DWELL). That sequence is the input PhoenixSource, PhoenixMOESource and PhoenixTopicsSource send to the retrieval model. Relevance: Out-of-network retrieval is driven by what each viewer engaged with, so an account's posts are plausibly more retrievable for viewers whose histories contain similar posts/authors. This is a viewer-side signal, not something an author controls directly. · Limitations: The aggregation service and the exact actions included per aggregation type are not in this repo; the meaning of UAS_WINDOW_TIME_MS passed here is not documented.	home-mixer/query_hydrators/retrieval_sequence_query_hydrator.rs:36-61	verified
A05	**Phoenix retrieval is a two-tower model over engagement history** Per phoenix/README.md, the user tower encodes the viewer's engagement history (plus one user-features token) into a normalized embedding, with no learned per-user ID embedding. The candidate tower embeds posts via semantic IDs plus hashed author IDs; the index is baked into the checkpoint, and serving retrieves top-K by dot product. Relevance: Main ML path by which non-followers can be shown an account's posts: posts whose content/author embeddings sit near a viewer's history embedding are more likely to be retrieved. Content similarity (semantic IDs) and author identity both enter the candidate representation. · Limitations: This is README prose; the code is phoenix/xrex/models/recsys_two_tower_model.py (RecsysTwoTowerModel, RecsysCandidateTower). The README also says retrieval is trained with favorites as the positive signal (phoenix/README.md lines 274-275). Production checkpoints, corpus and cluster configs are not published.	phoenix/README.md:99-121	verified
A07	**Cold-start retrieval pool: low-fav, low-view, fresh posts** cold_pool_mask keeps posts whose metadata shows view_count < max_views (default 500) and fav_count < max_favs (default 8); posts missing metadata are kept. retrieval_dataset.py combines this with fresh_post_mask(cold_start_max_age_seconds) to form the HOME_COLD slice of the home index, and the complement becomes HOME_HOT (DEFAULT_COLD_START_MAX_AGE_SECONDS = 2 * 60 * 60). Relevance: Young posts that have not yet accumulated many views or likes appear to be eligible for a separate cold-start retrieval slice, which could give small accounts' new posts some out-of-network exposure; eligibility appears to end once a post crosses the view/fav/age limits. · Limitations: Defaults are function defaults in training/indexing code (phoenix/xrex); whether production serving passes other values (e.g. cold_start_max_age_seconds) is not shown. HOME_COLD is built from the 1fav_1day snapshot (retrieval_dataset.py line 280), so it presumably requires the post to be in the 1fav index (see A08).	phoenix/xrex/data/cold_pool_filter.py:16-51	verified
A08	**Phoenix retrieval index admission is triggered by favorite events** The rank-all candidate processor skips community posts and reposts, routes replies to separate reply indexes, and skips posts that visibility filtering would drop or that are adult (except an NSFW video index). For other posts, a Fav event source writes the post to the 1fav, 1fav_topic and 32fav (only if favoriteCount >= 32, lines 62-76) indexes; a PostCreation event writes a separate post-creation index. Relevance: Getting at least one like plausibly matters for an original post to enter the 1fav retrieval index that HOME/HOME_COLD slices are built from; posts that VF would drop or that are labelled adult are not indexed there, which would limit non-follower discovery. · Limitations: Which index each Phoenix retrieval cluster actually queries in production is configured outside this file. eventProcessing helpers (shouldDropPostByVF, isNsfwPost) are referenced but their full logic is elsewhere. lifecycle labels differ between strato files (some say Development).	phoenix-rankall-strato/columns/phoenix_rank_all/phoenixRankAllCandidateProcessor.strato:469-530	verified
A11	**SimClusters source constants (score floor, seed age, result caps)** SimclustersSource queries SimClusters ANN with cosine similarity over log-fav embeddings (MODEL_20M_145K_2020), ANN_MAX_NUM_RESULTS = 200 per seed, scanning up to 50 clusters. Results are kept only if score > POST_ANN_MIN_SCORE = 0.5, seeds must be no older than MAX_SEED_AGE (90 days), and the merged output is capped at MAX_RESULTS = 800. Relevance: A second out-of-network path: posts that are cluster-similar (by who favorites them) to posts the viewer engaged with can be surfaced to non-followers. Candidate age is bounded by SimclustersMaxCandidateAgeHours (default 48). · Limitations: The SimClusters embeddings and ANN service are in simclusters/ (Scala) and their training data is not published. The OONNsfwSimclustersFilter later removes SimClusters posts from adult-flagged authors the viewer does not follow.	home-mixer/sources/simclusters_source.rs:25-36	verified
A12	**SimClusters seeds come from the viewer's recent engagements** Seeds are the post ids from the viewer's explicit and implicit engagement signals, sorted by engaged_at_ms (most recent first) and deduplicated; seeds older than MAX_SEED_AGE are dropped. Each seed's ANN results are filtered by POST_ANN_MIN_SCORE, limited to MAX_SANN_CANDIDATES / number_of_seeds per seed, round-robin interleaved, and truncated to 800. Relevance: If viewers who engage with posts similar to an account's posts are numerous, the account's posts may be pulled in as similar candidates; engagement on an account's own posts also becomes a seed for that engager's future SimClusters retrieval. · Limitations: Per-type signal caps (EngagementSignalsMaxPerType, default 15) and the upstream engagement stores (twistly) are outside this file; caching (pod and shared caches, 600s pod TTL) can delay changes.	home-mixer/sources/simclusters_source.rs:222-252	verified
B01	**Predicted heads consumed by the value model** PhoenixScores lists the per-candidate predictions the value model reads: probability heads (favorite, reply, retweet, photo_expand, video_open, click, open_link, profile_click, vqv, share, share_via_dm, share_via_copy_link, dwell, quote, quoted_click, quoted_vqv, follow_author, post_unexplored, react_with_video), negative heads (not_interested, block_author, mute_author, report, not_dwelled) and continuous values (dwell_time, click_dwell_time, home_video_continuation_secs, home_profile_visit_secs). Relevance: These are the only engagement predictions that enter the weighted score; actions not listed (e.g. bookmark) have no direct weight in ranking. · Limitations: The mapping from Phoenix output indices to these fields is in the component_library (PredictNextActions::candidate_scores), not in this repo. Which heads a production checkpoint emits is not published.	xai-value-model/phoenix_scores.rs:1-31	verified
B03	**Published weights: like, reply, bidirectional boost, repost** param.rs sets FavoriteWeight 0.66, ReplyWeight 5.0, BidirectionalFollowReplyWeightBoost 15.0, BidirectionalFollowDwellWeightBoost 0.0 and RetweetWeight 1.0. Each multiplies a predicted probability for the viewer, not an engagement count.	home-mixer/params/param.rs:345-359	verified

	Relevance: Posts a viewer is predicted to reply to get relatively large weight per unit probability; the contribution also depends on how likely each action is, which the weights do not show. · Limitations: Line 1 states values are mirrored from config defaults (last sync 2026-10-22T16:00:34Z). README (Experiments and Configuration) says tunable values are read from a configuration system and that cron scripts set code defaults to the primary production values; per-user experiments can still override them.		
B04	**Published weights: clicks, expands, profile click 0, VQV 0** param.rs sets PhotoExpandWeight 0.05, VideoOpenWeight 0.02, ClickWeight 0.3, OpenLinkWeight 0.2, ProfileClickWeight 0.0 and VqvWeight 0.0. With weight 0.0, predicted profile clicks and video quality views add nothing to the weighted score. Relevance: Under these defaults, predicted profile clicks and video quality views do not raise a post's score; link opens and post clicks contribute small weights. · Limitations: VQV is additionally gated per candidate (vqv_eligible in home-mixer/util/candidates_util.rs: video duration > MinVideoDurationMs and a follower-count condition on the requesting user). README (Experiments and Configuration) says tunable values are read from a configuration system and that cron scripts set code defaults to the primary production values; per-user experiments can still override them.	home-mixer/params/param.rs:360-380	verified
B05	**Published weights: shares (copy link 20), dwell, quote** param.rs sets ShareWeight 2.0, ShareViaDmWeight 5.0, ShareViaCopyLinkWeight 20.0, DwellWeight 0.05 and QuoteWeight 5.0. share_via_copy_link has the largest positive weight in the file. Relevance: Posts viewers are predicted to share (especially via copy link or DM) or quote receive relatively high weight per unit probability; since such actions are presumably rare, the realized effect is uncertain. · Limitations: Weights scale predicted probabilities whose base rates differ by action, so weight size alone does not show relative influence. README (Experiments and Configuration) says tunable values are read from a configuration system and that cron scripts set code defaults to the primary production values; per-user experiments can still override them.	home-mixer/params/param.rs:381-395	verified
B06	**Published weights: follow_author, unexplored, continuous dwell** param.rs sets QuotedClickWeight 0.05, QuotedVqvWeight 0.0, FollowAuthorWeight 4.0, PostUnexploredWeight 0.015, ReactWithVideoWeight 0.0, ContDwellTimeWeight 0.006 and ContClickDwellTimeWeight 0.4. The cont_* weights multiply predicted continuous dwell values rather than probabilities. Relevance: Predicted probability that a viewer follows the author is rewarded, which could favour posts that convert non-followers; predicted dwell also contributes. PostUnexplored applies only to in-network candidates in home-mixer (see B17). · Limitations: Units/scale of predicted dwell_time and click_dwell_time are not documented. README (Experiments and Configuration) says tunable values are read from a configuration system and that cron scripts set code defaults to the primary production values; per-user experiments can still override them.	home-mixer/params/param.rs:396-437	verified
B08	**Weights multiply predicted probabilities; only Home Timeline engagement counts** The param.rs comment says each weight multiplies a predicted probability (or continuous value) and not raw engagement counts, so ratios such as report vs like are not count equivalences. It adds that the baseline report probability is more than 1000x lower than a like, and that for an engagement to count in the recommendation system it must happen on a post served in Home Timeline. Relevance: Coordinated engagement from people navigating directly to a post is described as having no ranking impact; reach depends on per-viewer predicted actions, not totals. · Limitations: The same comment appears in xai-value-model/scoring.rs (lines 28-56) and README.md lines 353-355. The '468' example matches 234/0.5 (the vm-ranker/params.rs favorite default), whereas param.rs now has 0.66 (inferred arithmetic). The training-label pipeline that enforces the Home Timeline rule is not shown in this file.	home-mixer/params/param.rs:316-344	verified
B12	**Author diversity decay and out-of-network discount (vm-ranker)** vm-ranker defaults: EnableAuthorDiversity true with AuthorDiversityDecay 0.5 and AuthorDiversityFloor 0.25, applied as (1 - floor) * decay^k + floor for an author's k-th post in the slate (scoring.rs diversity_multiplier). OonWeightFactor 0.75 multiplies out-of-network posts and, with EnableOonRescoreForInNetworkRepliesRetweets true, in-network replies/reposts; topic requests use TopicOonWeightFactor 0.5. Relevance: A non-follower sees an account's post at a 0.75 multiplier relative to an identical in-network post, and several posts from the same author in one slate get progressively discounted. · Limitations: These params are vm-ranker-only names (not in home-mixer param.rs); home-mixer's local value model disables author diversity and OON rescoring (B17), so on the RPC-failure fallback path these multipliers are not applied. NewUserAgeThresholdSecs defaults to 0, effectively disabling the new-user OON factor. README (Experiments and Configuration) says tunable values are read from a configuration system and that cron scripts set code defaults to the primary production values; per-user experiments can still override them.	vm-ranker/params.rs:169-228	verified
B13	**ComputeValueModel default false is overridden by the request flag** vm-ranker computes the value model when req.compute_value_model is true or the ComputeValueModel param is true (default false in vm-ranker/params.rs). home-mixer's RequestShape::build always sets compute_value_model: true with value_model_id "dpp", so the vm-ranker value model runs regardless of the param default; otherwise vm-ranker would pass through home-mixer's scores. Relevance: Means the vm-ranker weights, author diversity and OON factor (B11/B12) are the ones applied on the normal path, followed by DPP diversity reordering (DppEnabled true, DppTheta 0.65 in vm-ranker/params.rs lines 235-247). · Limitations: If vm-ranker has no resolved config it falls back to upstream scores (reason no_config); home-mixer/scorers/vm_ranker_request.rs lines 37-45 hold the request flag.	vm-ranker/scoring/mod.rs:31-35	verified
B15	**Bidirectional boost eligibility: mutual-follow original posts only** reply_weight_for returns reply + bidirectional_follow_reply_weight_boost when the boost is non-zero and the candidate is bidirectional_boost_eligible, defined in inputs.rs as not a reply, not a repost, and is_mutual_follow_author. Mutual status is hydrated by BidirectionalFollowHydrator (EnableBidirectionalFollowHydration default true). Relevance: With ReplyWeight 5.0 and boost 15.0 the effective reply weight for eligible posts is 20.0 in home-mixer defaults (arithmetic); only original posts benefit, not the author's replies or reposts. · Limitations: Mutual-follow check uses the social graph at request time; failures return errors for the hydrator.	xai-value-model/weights.rs:84-100	verified
C07	**No user-cred input in the For You value-model scoring path** The per-candidate inputs to the value model are predicted engagement scores plus author id, in-network, reply/retweet, mutual-follow and video eligibility flags; there is no user-cred, PageRank or verification field. A search of home-mixer, vm-ranker and xai-value-model finds no reference to user cred or page rank. In bdsm the user_cred_norm feature is filled with zeros. Relevance: In this code, the final weighted score does not appear to apply a direct reputation multiplier. Cred can still matter indirectly through labels whose application it gates (C05/C06/C10/C11), which visibility filtering can act on. · Limitations:	xai-value-model/inputs.rs:3-17	inferred

	This is a negative result from searching the published code. The Phoenix model's own input features are not fully audited here, and a TweetEmbedding thrift struct in phoenix/crates/serving/xai-recsys-mm-server/src/events.rs carries a user_credibility field whose use was not traced.		
C11	**Grox reply spam flags replies with RiskyHighVizReply unless high cred (>= 66)** The reply_spam flow scores replies; when the reply-ranking score is 0.0 it applies the RiskyHighVizReply post label unless the author's user-cred is >= 66 (or the high-PageRank flag when no score), the author has a grey badge, or is a test user. Separately, scarecrow rule 25026 applies RISKY_HIGH_VIZ_REPLY for 14 days when a Grox spamScore >= 0.97, unless the reply is by the conversation author or the author is high-PageRank, skip-listed or gray verified. Relevance: Low-cred accounts that leave replies judged spammy may have those replies labelled; the rule name suggests a downrank of the reply, but where the label is consumed is not in this repo. · Limitations: The consumer of RiskyHighVizReply (e.g. conversation reply ordering) is not present; the effect on reach is inferred from the label name only. Prompts are withheld. See botmaker-rules/scarecrow/bot/GroxTweetProcessor.bot for rule 25026.	grox/flows/reply_spam/task_write.py:39-80	verified
C12	**Grox prompts withheld; UPA "banger" screen and multimodal embeddings** Grox runs LLM/VLM flows on posts: ptos (safety/spam policy), reply_spam, upa (an initial "banger" screen and post-safety screen that send boolean metadata to a labelling endpoint) and mm_emb (multimodal post embeddings). The prompt templates (.j2) are excluded from the repo; each prompts.py says so in a comment. Relevance: Grox outputs can become post labels that visibility filtering acts on, but the classification criteria are not public, so a specific post's risk cannot be predicted from code alone. · Limitations: The README lists Grox prompts among withheld files. How UPA labels are used downstream (grok_upa_action_with_labels) is not shown. mm_emb gates embedding by an adaptive minimum fav count (grox/flows/mm_emb/adaptive_min_fav.py).	grox/flows/ptos/prompts.py:11-11	verified
C15	**botmaker-rules label duplicate-text replies as COPYPASTA_SPAM (some rules withheld)** Rule 21599 consumes scheduled BigQuery jobs that cluster replies with duplicate text (unigrams, or characters for CJK) and applies the COPYPASTA_SPAM label to each reply, skipping test users, high-PageRank users, a temporary skip list and gray-verified users. Some botmaker rules are deliberately not published. Relevance: Posting the same or near-identical reply text repeatedly could plausibly get replies labelled; the rule's own note calls this a downrank, but the label's ranking effect is not shown in this repo. · Limitations: README.md line 433 lists "Some botmaker rules" as withheld. The clustering query and its similarity thresholds are not published.	botmaker-rules/scarecrow/bot/BBQDuplicateTextRepliesProd.bot:25-46	verified
C16	**Visibility-filtering verdicts are Withheld (Drop/Tombstone) or Shown with notices** The visibility-filtering service returns either Withheld (Drop or Tombstone) or Shown with optional notice (soft intervention, appealable notice, label interstitial), media restriction and limited-engagement parts. Per the README, the first rule that answers drop ends evaluation. Relevance: Only drop-type outcomes remove a post from For You in home-mixer (see D13); notices and interstitials change presentation, not eligibility, in the code read here. · Limitations: The mapping from Verdict to the client Action enum used by home-mixer (Allow, Interstitial, Avoid, Downrank, Drop, Tombstone, NotEvaluated) was not fully traced.	visibility-filtering/models/verdict.rs:8-26	verified
D04	**Out-of-network reposts and replies are filtered out** Reposts from accounts the viewer does not follow are removed, as are out-of-network replies unless EnablePhoenixOonReplies is on and the reply came from Phoenix retrieval (optionally only replies to the root). Any reply whose ancestors failed to hydrate is removed regardless of network. Relevance: Replies and reposts mostly reach For You only for the author's followers; with EnablePhoenixOonReplies defaulting to false, an account's replies are unlikely to be recommended to non-followers through this pipeline. · Limitations: EnablePhoenixOonReplies default (false) is from home-mixer/params/param.rs; experiments can enable it for some viewers.	home-mixer/filters/oon_retweet_reply_filter.rs:15-28	verified
D09	**Author diversity multiplier decays repeated authors within one feed** Candidates are ordered by score; the k-th additional post from the same author in that request (k = 0 for the first) is multiplied by (1 - floor) * decay^k + floor. With defaults decay 0.5 and floor 0.25 this gives 1.0, 0.625, 0.4375, ... approaching 0.25. Relevance: Several posts by the same author competing for one viewer's feed are progressively discounted; this is per viewer per request, not a global penalty on posting frequency. · Limitations: Defaults are in vm-ranker/params.rs (lines 169-186). Home-mixer's local fallback scoring disables author diversity (home-mixer/scorers/value_model.rs).	xai-value-model/scoring.rs:183-204	verified
D10	**Out-of-network discount (OonWeightFactor 0.75), also for in-network replies/reposts** The OON multiplier applies to out-of-network candidates and, when EnableOonRescoreForInNetworkRepliesRetweets is true (default), to in-network replies and reposts. The multiplier is the request's effective_oon_weight: OonWeightFactor (0.75) normally, TopicOonWeightFactor (0.5) for topic requests, or NewUserOonWeightFactor for eligible new viewers. Relevance: Reaching non-followers carries a 25% score discount at defaults, so out-of-network posts need higher predicted engagement to rank equally. · Limitations: Defaults from vm-ranker/params.rs lines 205-228; production values can differ per experiment bucket.	xai-value-model/scoring.rs:206-251	verified
D13	**VFFilter drops only Drop/Tombstone/NotEvaluated; Downrank/Avoid kept** After selection, VFFilter removes candidates whose visibility action is Drop, Tombstone or NotEvaluated. Allow, Interstitial, Avoid and Downrank are kept, and no other home-mixer code was found that changes scores based on Avoid or Downrank. Relevance: Visibility filtering affects For You reach mainly by dropping posts. A post whose VF lookup failed (NotEvaluated) would also be dropped. · Limitations: The absence of Downrank/Avoid handling is from a search of home-mixer only; other services could use them.	home-mixer/filters/vf_filter.rs:22-27	verified
D17	**Debias payload with has_url is sent to vm-ranker only when enabled (default off)** When VMRankerSendDebiasInputs is true and the request has no cached posts, home-mixer adds per-candidate content features to the vm-ranker request: has_video, video duration, has_photo, media count, weighted text length, newline count and has_url (external URLs in text). The parameter defaults to false, and the value model shown here does not read these fields. Relevance: No URL penalty appears in the published scoring formula; has_url is only an experimental payload field whose use by vm-ranker is not shown. · Limitations: Default from home-mixer/params/param.rs lines 502-507. How vm-ranker experiments consume experiment_payload is not in this repo.	home-mixer/scorers/vm_ranker_request.rs:17-24	verified
D19	**Cold-start lift for low-impression posts from smaller authors** AuthorColdStart can lift one eligible candidate per request to the score at a randomly chosen target rank. Eligible posts	home-mixer/scorers/auth	verified

are originals (not replies or reposts) from authors with <= 50,000 followers, younger than 7,200 s, with fewer than 200 home impressions, within an allowed position range, and in the viewer's experiment arm's author corpus. Relevance: Small accounts' fresh original posts can get an exploratory boost early in their life; replies and reposts are not eligible. · Limitations: Defaults from home-mixer/params/param.rs (lines 539-581); slot range and corpus bucketing are experiment-controlled.	or_cold_start.rs:188-193

9. Competitive comparison

Same slice for client and peers: authored posts, last 90 days, mature only.

Account	Followers	Posts/wk	Typical views (median)	Views / 1k followers	Eng /1k views	Replies /1k	Bookmarks /1k	Article share
@MichLieben	**13,338**	**12.1**	**4,091**	**306.7**	**16.5**	**0.98**	**8.76**	**33%**
@itsalexvacca	36,433	5.2	8,184	224.6	16.1	0.49	8.78	77%
@RetentionAdam	10,865	2.1	2,343	215.6	15.2	2.54	2.76	4%
@coldemailchris	21,620	12.4	4,772	220.7	23.6	1.81	9.46	21%
@danielfazio	17,746	7.6	9,686	545.8	16.7	1.30	2.02	0%
@cbwritescopy	36,471	21.8	2,536	69.5	17.3	2.17	2.44	0%

- Peers: newest <=100 original posts per peer in the window were collected; posting rate is computed over the span those posts cover.
- Size normalisation: views per 1,000 followers uses follower counts observed on the snapshot date, applied to the whole window (no follower history).
- Engagement per 1,000 views is size-independent but depends on audience composition.
- Peer reply/comment behaviour was not collected; the commenting audit has no peer benchmark.
- Quote-post share is not compared: peers were collected with the console's 'original' filter.
- Peer topic mix uses the heuristic labeller (keywords), not the reviewed labels used for clients.

10. Post rewrites (editorial proposals to test)

> A rewrite is an editorial proposal; it is not predicted to receive more distribution. Each comes with a measurable test.

1. quote post · 2026-10-19 16:02 UTC · 118 views (0.03x baseline)

> Original: 24 people on our team posted on LinkedIn using @PierreReddot's playbook. In 85 days, that helped us sign 27 new clients & $151K in new MRR.
>
> We were clients of his agency at one point. It worked so well we took it in-house, and got him to teach the team too.
>
> I had him on my YouTube a few months ago to go through how he makes his posts. What I took from it:
>
> - A lot of his infographics are comparisons. B2B vs B2C, marketing vs sales lead systems, that kind of thing. He says "people love comparing stuff" and it helps them pick what's right for them
>
> - On the episode we started an outbound one live in Canva. We kept the wrong side super basic on purpose (send a lot of emails, ask for a demo in email 1, big list) because he wanted it really obvious that's the wrong way, and the right side was supposed to be the long technical stuff. We didn't finish it but you get the idea
>
> - Title as big as possible. People usually read the title, go top to bottom, and only read the caption if the graphic got them interested
>
> - He adds a small note on the graphic for context. On his 4 levels of B2B marketing one, it just says "most businesses start here". Most people skip strategy and go straight to tactics, that's the point of it
>
> - He guessed 60-70% of his posts start with a problem, agitate it, then give the fix. When he starts positive, he uses what he calls an "authority mark", like "I've been doing marketing for 10 years"
>
> - No "comment to get the guide" posts. He wants his profile to feel like a safe place to learn. I still run plenty of those haha so not following this one
>
> - Last one, probably the most true. He told us "you can have the best frameworks, best systems, but if people don't do it... the posts don't go live." For us the thing that made the team actually post was a quarterly competition with cash prizes (plus $500 for anyone who posted 20+ times in a quarter)
>
> He's back on X now and says he'll teach this stuff here. Go give him a follow 👇

Observed issue	118 views against a 3,855-view baseline (0.03x, the lowest in this set). The 59.3 engagements per 1k views come from only 7 interactions (3 likes, 1 reply, 2 reposts, 1 bookmark).
Can conclude	This quote post reached about 3% of the account's recent median, and the few people who saw it interacted at a high rate. It sits in 'resonance without reach'.
Cannot conclude	With 118 views, 7 interactions is too small a sample to trust the engagement rate. We can't tell whether the quote format, the length, the shout-out framing (promoting another creator) or timing caused the low reach. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> 24 people on our team posted on LinkedIn using @PierreReddot's playbook. In 85 days, that helped us sign 27 new clients & $151K in new MRR.
>
> We were clients of his agency first. It worked so well we took it in-house.
>
> What I took from having him on my YouTube:
>
> - Comparisons work. "People love comparing stuff" and it helps them pick what's right for them
> - Title as big as possible. People read the title, go top to bottom, and only read the caption if the graphic got them
> - Add a small note on the graphic for context, like "most businesses start here"
> - He guessed 60-70% of his posts start with a problem, agitate it, then give the fix
>
> Honestly the thing that made our team actually post was a quarterly competition with cash prizes (plus $500 for anyone who posted 20+ times in a quarter).
>
> He's back on X teaching this. Which one would you try first?

Editorial changes	• Published as a standalone post so the result and the takeaways don't depend on the quoted tweet. • Cut from 7 takeaways to 4 plus the team-incentive point, cutting it from about 385 words to about 160 (the audit found long posts underperform this account's baseline). • Kept the personal hook (our team, our clients, my YouTube) and every original figure unchanged. Fact flag: the original says 85 days and $151K, while other ColdIQ material says 87 days and $153K. Verify before publishing. • Replaced the 'go give him a follow' close with a single question to invite replies, keeping the @PierreReddot credit in the first line.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.03x, replies per 1k (original 8.5) and bookmarks per 1k (original 8.5). Treat the result as one data point.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

2. quote post · 2026-09-30 16:55 UTC · 281 views (0.07x baseline)

> Original: Our gtm funnel turns 40,000 visitors a month into 100+ meetings
>
> how:
>
> one video a week becomes shorts, linkedin posts, x posts and a newsletter
>
> search brings about 12,000 visits a month across 4 kinds of pages, from articles to free mini tools
>
> identify the silent visitors, the ones who read and leave (rb2b, instantly, coldiq visitor id)
>
> land every lead as a card in folk and have claude code score it against your icp file
>
> a top-band lead gets a rep the same day. an opted-in lead in a lower band gets a sequence or the newsletter
>
> run every sales call through claap, and let a claude skill turn the transcript into a proposal
>
> start with 3 of the 40 tools: claude code, the coldiq mcp and folk
>
> full stack, stage by stage, in the article below

Observed issue	281 views against a 4,046.5-view baseline (0.07x). Only 3 interactions (1 like, 1 reply, 1 bookmark), 10.7 per 1k views.
Can conclude	The post reached about 7% of the recent median and drew low engagement from the people who saw it ('neither' quadrant).
Cannot conclude	We can't tell whether the quote-of-own-article format, the dense stage-by-stage walkthrough, the lowercase style or the posting slot drove the result, or whether the linked article got clicks we don't observe. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> Our gtm funnel turns 40,000 visitors a month into 100+ meetings.
>
> The step I'd copy first: identify the silent visitors, the ones who read and leave, land each one as a card in folk, and have claude code score it against your icp file.
>
> A top-band lead gets a rep the same day.

Editorial changes	• Turned the quote post into a standalone post that carries one insight instead of a 7-stage list (the audit found very dense lists underperform this account's baseline). • Picked the single most transferable step (scoring silent visitors against the icp file) and framed it as what Mich would copy first. • Kept the original numbers (40,000 visitors, 100+ meetings) and tool names, and kept his lowercase style. • Dropped the 'article below' close. If the article link matters, put it in a reply instead of the main post.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day, standalone, with the article link in the first reply. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.07x and engagements per 1k against 10.7. Also log article clicks from the reply if available.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

3. short post · 2026-08-27 12:00 UTC · 455 views (0.07x baseline)

> Original: Here's the right way to copy a viral format on LinkedIn for your own account. https://t.co/GN6fpk4RbR

Observed issue	455 views against a 6,093-view baseline (0.07x). Zero likes, replies and reposts. All 5 interactions were bookmarks (11.0 per 1k views).
Can conclude	People who saw it saved it but didn't respond publicly. The text gives no detail on the method itself, which sits in the attachment.
Cannot conclude	We can't see the attached media, so we can't judge its quality or whether people opened it. With 5 interactions on 455 views, the bookmark rate is a small sample. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> Here's how I'd copy a viral LinkedIn format for my own account, the right way.
>
> Full walkthrough attached.
>
> Which format have you been wanting to copy?

Editorial changes	• Switched from a generic 'here's the right way' to a first-person how-to ('how I'd copy'), in line with the audit's finding that personal experience is associated with higher reach. • Re-attach the same media. The text says outright that the walkthrough is attached, so readers know there's something to open. • Added a reply prompt, since the original got 0 replies. • Didn't add any steps from the walkthrough. We can't see the media, so a human should add one concrete step from it before publishing rather than having it invented here.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day with the same media. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.07x and replies per 1k against 0. Keep an eye on whether the bookmark rate stays near 11.0 per 1k.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

4. long post · 2026-05-18 13:36 UTC · 893 views (0.09x baseline)

Original: I've sent 10M+ cold messages last year via my $7M ARR GTM agency. Now I spend more time cleaning my inbox than launching campaigns.

200+ pitches hit my inbox this month. I reply to almost none of them. But for a change, I went through this month's pile and pulled out the few I would actually engaged with. Four clear patterns showed up:

WHAT EARNS A REPLY

1. Real work, already done.
Some people offered to rewrite our landing pages. Others offered to draft sample scripts for our YouTube. We used to run this play in ColdIQ's early days, giving away custom lead lists for free, and got back more replies than we knew what to do with. Pro tip: imagine the prospect already signed. What's the first thing you'd ship for them? Do it already.

2. A specific internal referral ask.
If you've actually researched what we're working on at ColdIQ and figured out who owns it, I'll happily route you to the right person. You can scale this play by stacking buying signals in @clay with their "find person" feature to surface a colleague in a specific department.

3. A free insight, not a "free consultation."
The sharpest take on this came from Jihad Iqbal: the best "free work" isn't work, it's insights. A 5-minute technical audit. 3 specific optimization opportunities. No strings attached. Something like: "Your checkout flow has a 23% drop-off at payment verification. Here's why + 2 quick fixes." Takes 10 minutes. Shows instant value. Demonstrates expertise without asking for anything.

4. A notorious sender.
A bit unfair, but who sends the message matters as much as the message itself. If a public figure in your space (e.g. Alex Hormozi) sent you the worst LinkedIn DM ever, you'd still want to reply. I watched my own reply rates greatly increase as I built up my personal brand. Pro tip: if you're in B2B, build up your LinkedIn profile.

WHAT KILLS THE PITCH

1. "Can I pick your brain?"
I'd love to, but time is tight and there's little to no upside for me.

2. Copy-pasted templates.
Plenty of teams still run pure-volume plays, blasting the same template to everyone. Appealing to everyone = appealing to no one. You're wasting your DMs.

3. "Got 30 min for a quick sync?"
If the first thing you do is ask me for 30 min of my time, I'll find a way out.

Observed issue	893 views against a 10,058-view baseline (0.09x). 16 bookmarks against 8 likes, 1 reply and 0 reposts (28.0 engagements per 1k).
Can conclude	Saves outnumbered every other interaction, so readers treated it as reference material, but reach was under a tenth of the recent median ('resonance without reach').
Cannot conclude	We can't tell whether the length (about 400 words), the credential opener, the two-part list structure or the timing held reach back. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

Now I spend more time cleaning my inbox than launching campaigns. 200+ pitches hit it this month and I reply to almost none.

So I went through the pile and pulled out the few I'd actually engage with. Four patterns:

1. Real work, already done. Some people offered to rewrite our landing pages. We ran this play in ColdIQ's early days, giving away custom lead lists for free, and got back more replies than we knew what to do with.

2. A specific internal referral ask. If you've figured out who owns it at ColdIQ, I'll happily route you to the right person.

3. A free insight, not a "free consultation." Jihad Iqbal put it best: the best free work is insights. A 5-minute technical audit, no strings attached.

4. A notorious sender. A bit unfair, but I watched my own reply rates go up as I built my personal brand.

What kills it for me: "Can I pick your brain?", copy-pasted templates, and "Got 30 min for a quick sync?" as the first ask.

Which of these has actually worked on you?

Editorial changes	• Opened on the personal inbox observation instead of the 10M+ / $7M ARR credential, which keeps it first-person and shortens the hook. • Cut the length from about 400 words to about 180 by trimming the pro tips and folding the 'what kills it' list into one line (the audit found long posts underperform this account's baseline). • Removed the hypothetical '23% drop-off' example so the post contains no illustrative stat that could read as a real client result. • Ended with a question to invite replies (the original got 1 reply on 893 views).
Test	Publish as the first post of the day. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.09x, replies per 1k (original 1.1) and bookmarks per 1k (original 17.9).

Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

5. short post · 2026-08-21 10:38 UTC · 779 views (0.11x baseline)

> Original: Stop blasting emails to 10,000 leads before you know what a good lead looks like.
>
> Send 50 by hand first.
>
> Open every profile, and note what the ones who reply have in common.
>
> Those shared data points are your filter, and you cannot guess them in advance. https://t.co/W4ORVKg6jP

Observed issue	779 views against a 7,117-view baseline (0.11x). 16 interactions (7 likes, 1 reply, 2 reposts, 6 bookmarks), 20.5 per 1k views.
Can conclude	Engagement from viewers was decent for its reach ('resonance without reach'), but views were about a tenth of the recent median.
Cannot conclude	We can't tell whether the 'Stop...' contrarian opener (an underperforming hook type for this account across the audit, not proven for this post), the attachment or the timing explains the gap. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> How I'd figure out what a good lead looks like before blasting emails to 10,000 of them:
>
> Send 50 by hand first. Open every profile, and note what the ones who reply have in common.
>
> Those shared data points become your filter. You can't guess them in advance.

Editorial changes	• Swapped the 'Stop blasting' contrarian opener for a first-person how-to opener. The audit found how-to posts outperform and contrarian openers underperform this account's baseline. • Kept the method and both numbers (10,000 and 50) unchanged. • Merged two lines so the steps read as one flow instead of stacked commands. • Re-attach the same media.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day with the same media. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.11x and engagements per 1k against 20.5. This isolates the opener change (contrarian vs how-to) as far as one post can.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

6. long post · 2026-04-30 13:00 UTC · 1,452 views (0.11x baseline)

> Original: The exact 8-step system that helps us generate 20M+ impressions on LinkedIn (while also adding ~ $5M in ARR along the way):
>
> 1. Pick your ideal buyer.
> > A lot of "viral" content doesn't convert because it's written for the creator's competitors, not their buyers. Understand your ICP and write content that serves them.
>
> 2. Map who actually surfaces it.
> > Your buyer might not scroll. Their team does. Make something the team forwards up to them.
>
> 3. Audit before you write.
> > Your own posts: which ones outperformed? Make more of those + variations.
> > Competitor posts: how do you make them sharper, simpler, or better looking?
> > Thought leaders in your niche: what's the quality gap, and how fast can you close it?
>
> 4. Build a swipe file.
> > Pull outlier posts in your niche by author, keyword, or adjacent vertical. Taplio and Scripe do this in seconds.
> > Adapt the format to your subject.
>
> 5. Lock 2-3 topics + a few recurring formats.
> > Topics: AI agents, GTM tech.
> > Formats: tools carousel, schema infographic.
> > Run them weekly. Same topics, same formats, every week.
> > Content doesn't need to be new. It needs to be shown to people who haven't seen it.
>
> 6. Rotate TOF / MOF / BOF.
> > TOF: brings new people in
> > MOF: piques interest in your offer
> > BOF: drives action
> > A single post rarely does all 3. Pick the goal before you publish.
>
> 7. Strong visuals = more reach.
> > An image is worth 1,000 words. A video is thousands of images. Attention-grabbing designs always improve reach.
>
> 8. Hand the playbook to your team.
> > You can't post 2+ times a day from one account without losing reach. But more posts = more total impressions.
> > The fix: get your team posting too.

Observed issue	1,452 views against a 12,681-view baseline (0.11x). 23 bookmarks against 16 likes, 1 reply and 0 reposts (27.5 per 1k views).
Can conclude	Readers saved it at a high rate relative to other actions, but it reached about 11% of the recent median ('resonance without reach').
Cannot conclude	We can't tell whether the 8-step dense list, the length, the result-number hook or the posting slot caused the low reach. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> We've done 20M+ impressions on LinkedIn (and added ~$5M in ARR along the way). Here's what it actually comes down to.
>
> We picked our ideal buyer and wrote for them. A lot of "viral" content doesn't convert because it's written for the creator's competitors, not their buyers.
>
> We locked 2-3 topics (AI agents, GTM tech) and a few recurring formats (tools carousel, schema infographic) and ran them every week. Content doesn't need to be new. It needs to be shown to people who haven't seen it.
>
> We pick the goal before each post: bring new people in, get them interested in the offer, or drive action. A single post rarely does all 3.
>
> And we handed the playbook to the team. You can't post 2+ times a day from one account without losing reach, so more people posting means more total impressions.
>
> Which part would you start with?

Editorial changes	• Cut the 8 numbered steps with nested '>' bullets down to 4 short paragraphs, keeping the steps that carry Mich's own experience (buyer focus, fixed topics and formats, TOF/MOF/BOF, team posting). • Rewrote in 'we' so it reads as what ColdIQ did, not a generic checklist (the audit associates personal experience with higher reach). • Dropped the tool mentions (Taplio, Scripe) and the visuals step to bring the length down from about 300 words to about 150. • Kept every original figure (20M+, ~$5M ARR, 2-3 topics, 2+ posts a day) and ended with a reply question.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.11x, replies per 1k (original 0.7) and bookmarks per 1k (original 15.8).
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

7. short post · 2026-08-24 11:00 UTC · 831 views (0.13x baseline)

> Original: Going from an 8/10 cold email to a 9/10 can mean up to 100x more replies.
>
> Score the timing, relevance, and ask separately.
>
> Fix the lowest score first. Then send a small batch and grade it again. https://t.co/QDSqEyUUHk

Observed issue	831 views against a 6,376.5-view baseline (0.13x). 11 bookmarks against 8 likes, 1 reply and 1 repost (25.3 per 1k views).
Can conclude	Bookmarks led the interactions, so it was saved as a how-to, but reach was about 13% of the recent median ('resonance without reach').
Cannot conclude	The '100x more replies' claim was not tested, and we can't tell whether the hook, the attachment or the timing affected reach. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> How I'd grade a cold email before sending it:
>
> Score the timing, relevance, and ask separately. Fix the lowest score first. Then send a small batch and grade it again.
>
> Going from an 8/10 to a 9/10 can mean up to 100x more replies.
>
> Which of the three do you usually score lowest?

Editorial changes	• Led with a first-person how-to line and moved the '8/10 to 9/10' claim after the method, so the post opens on the process (how-to posts outperform for this account). • Kept the claim word for word, including its 'can mean up to' hedge, and added no new figures. • Added a question tied to the three scoring dimensions to invite replies (the original got 1 reply on 831 views). • Re-attach the same media.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day with the same media. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.13x, replies per 1k (original 1.2) and bookmarks per 1k (original 13.2).
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

8. short post · 2026-08-31 14:30 UTC · 750 views (0.13x baseline)

> Original: Your outbound data already knows your best persona. We're building the engine that tells you exactly that. https://t.co/miJAN0E4Ft

Observed issue	750 views against a 5,688-view baseline (0.13x). 9 interactions (6 likes, 2 replies, 0 reposts, 1 bookmark), 12.0 per 1k views.
Can conclude	This announcement reached about 13% of the recent median and got few saves (1 bookmark) compared with the account's how-to posts in this set.
Cannot conclude	We can't tell whether announcement posts underperform in general from one post, or whether the attachment, the vague product description or timing played a role. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> Your outbound data already knows your best persona.
>
> We're building the engine that tells you exactly that, and I'd love input while we build it: what's the first thing you'd want it to show you?

Editorial changes	• Kept the original claim and announcement word for word, with no product details, dates or results added. • Turned the announcement into an open request for input, since this post already drew 2 replies, the most of any short post in this set. • Moved the hook onto its own line so it reads as a standalone statement. • Re-attach the same media.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day with the same media. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.13x and replies per 1k against 2.7. Read the replies as qualitative product input.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

9. short post · 2026-08-20 11:33 UTC · 1,160 views (0.16x baseline)

> Original: Stop emailing everyone who just raised. They got 100 identical congrats emails that same week and replied to none of them.
>
> What you could do instead: https://t.co/VHvtCFFIlW

Observed issue	1,160 views against a 7,117-view baseline (0.16x). 21 interactions (9 likes, 1 reply, 2 reposts, 9 bookmarks), 18.1 per 1k views.
Can conclude	Viewers engaged and saved it at a moderate rate, but it reached about 16% of the recent median ('resonance without reach').
Cannot conclude	The alternative play lives in the attachment, which we can't see, so we can't judge it. We also can't tell whether the 'Stop...' opener or timing contributed. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> Everyone who just raised gets 100 identical congrats emails that same week, and replies to none of them.
>
> Here's what you could do instead 👇
>
> Have you ever had a funding email actually land?

Editorial changes	• Dropped the 'Stop emailing' imperative and led with the observation behind it. The audit found contrarian openers underperform this account's baseline, and the mich-voice-checker flags 'Stop X' as off-voice. • Kept the original fact (100 identical congrats emails) and the attachment-led structure. • Added a reply question for people who run funding-trigger outbound. • Re-attach the same media.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day with the same media. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.16x and replies per 1k against 0.9.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

10. quote post · 2026-08-18 23:42 UTC · 1,191 views (0.17x baseline)

> Original: no one in the history of money has read "comfort is the enemy of growth" and then booked a sales call https://t.co/vL0P3fZgtc

Observed issue	1,191 views against a 7,185-view baseline (0.17x). 18 interactions (7 likes, 3 replies, 0 reposts, 8 bookmarks), 15.1 per 1k views. It was posted at 23:42 UTC.
Can conclude	This one-liner drew the most replies in this set (3), but it reached about 17% of the recent median.
Cannot conclude	We can't see the quoted tweet, so we don't know how much of the meaning or the reach depended on it. The late-night UTC posting time is observed, but its effect is not. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> no one in the history of money has read "comfort is the enemy of growth" and then booked a sales call.
>
> what's the last post that actually made you book one?

Editorial changes	• Made it standalone so the joke doesn't need the quoted tweet for context. • Kept the original line and lowercase style unchanged. • Added a follow-up question that turns the joke into a prompt about content that converts, building on the 3 replies it already got. • Didn't add any claim about what does convert for ColdIQ, since the original makes none.
Test	Publish standalone as the first post of the day, at a daytime UTC slot rather than near midnight. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.17x and replies per 1k against 2.5. Timing and format both change, so treat the result as directional only.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

11. quote post · 2026-04-28 22:30 UTC · 3,565 views (0.18x baseline)

> Original: if you post on linkedin, your cheapest pipeline is sitting in the likes and comments. wrote the 5-step process for turning it into meetings. https://t.co/8IaWP9dPAN

Observed issue	3,565 views against a 20,345.5-view baseline (0.18x). 0 replies, with 26 bookmarks, 14 likes and 1 repost (11.5 per 1k views).
Can conclude	It got the most views in this set but still under a fifth of its own (high) baseline. Saves outnumbered likes and it got no replies.
Cannot conclude	We can't tell how many people clicked through to the quoted article, which is where the 5-step process lives. The 22:30 UTC posting time is observed, but its effect is not. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

> If you post on LinkedIn, your cheapest pipeline is sitting in the likes and comments.
>
> I wrote up the 5-step process I'd use to turn those people into meetings.
>
> Is anyone actually doing something with their post engagers right now?

Editorial changes	• Kept it as a quote of the article, since X Articles are this account's strongest format and the 5 steps live there. • Kept the original hook unchanged and made the second line first-person. • Added a direct question to invite replies (the original got 0 replies on 3,565 views). • Didn't summarise the 5 steps, because they aren't in the post text and shouldn't be invented.
Test	Publish as a quote of the same article, as the first post of the day at a daytime UTC slot. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.18x, replies per 1k against 0 and bookmarks per 1k against 7.3. Log article views if available.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

12. long post · 2026-05-13 14:30 UTC · 2,340 views (0.18x baseline)

Original: Most people see one part of ColdIQ, usually the LinkedIn content, and assume that's the engine. It's not. The thing that pulls 55,000+ visits a month and supports $7M ARR has four layers:

marketing brings traffic in > lead capture turns it into pipeline > sales closes > and delivery scales the work without breaking.

1. Marketing (55,000+ visits/mo)

This is where the traffic enters. Five channels carry the load.

> LinkedIn (~15,000 visits/mo). The heaviest lifter. We have 20+ teammates publishing 150+ posts a month across outbound, AI, and GTM, with a combined audience of about 300K, designed in-house. Stack: Taplio, Scripe.

> SEO (~10,000 visits/mo). Yevhen runs programmatic SEO. Long-form blogs, programmatic landing pages on AirOps, and free micro-tools that Sacha builds in Claude Code. Stack: AirOps, Ahrefs, Claude Code, Webflow.

> Paid (~6,000 visits/mo). Ivan runs roughly $10K/mo across LinkedIn, Meta, and Google, mostly to test new channels rather than scale a winner. Stack: Claude Code, Fibbler, Usermaven.

> Cold outreach (~4,000 visits/mo). Kenny runs internal campaigns off tight lists of fewer than 5,000 deeply enriched contacts at a time, rotating between value-driven lead magnets, lookalike account targeting, social engagement plays, and inbound-led outbound. Stack: Clay, Claude Code, Apollo, Instantly, lemlist, Prospeo, FullEnrich, CompanyEnrich, PredictLeads.

> Newsletter, webinars, and emerging channels (~11,000 visits/mo). Monika ships the beehiiv newsletter. Harry runs the webinars. TikTok, Instagram, and X are newer experiments growing share fast.

2. Lead capture

Traffic alone doesn't convert, so lead capture is its own layer sitting on top of marketing.

> Midbound and Vector surface anonymous visitors.
> Customer .io handles lifecycle emails.
> Micro-tools and pop-up lead magnets quietly collect emails.
> Everything routes through n8n and gets scored in real time by Clay, OpenAI, and PredictLeads before a salesperson ever sees it.

3. Sales

> Sales-led motion, 2 to 3 Google Meet calls, $5K to $10K/month retainers.
> The qualifying happens before discovery. Case studies, VSL, and free content do the weeding.
> Once a call is booked, Clay enriches the account on funding, headcount, tech stack, tenure, and reports, and the proposal goes out shortly after.
> Stack: Attio for CRM, Attention for AI notes, Hyperline for CPQ, Qwilr for proposals, Stripe for payments.

4. Client delivery

> n8n runs the kickoff workflow.
> GSuite, Supabase, Stripe, and Slack are synced so admin tasks like Slack invites, onboarding links, and domain provisioning happen without anyone in the loop.
> Our GTM engineers only touch what moves the needle for clients: custom ICP matrix, creative campaign concepts, copy.

(bookmark for later)

Observed issue	2,340 views against a 13,239.5-view baseline (0.18x). 52 bookmarks (the most in this set) against 26 likes, 1 reply and 1 repost (34.2 per 1k views).
Can conclude	Readers treated it as reference material: bookmarks were double the likes. Reach was still under a fifth of the recent median ('resonance without reach').
Cannot conclude	We can't tell whether the length (about 430 words), the stack-heavy list format or the timing held reach back, or whether a shorter version would keep the save rate. This is a single post, so it is not a pattern. Posting time, who was online, competing posts that day, how the post was distributed and ranking internals are unobserved, so the gap to baseline cannot be attributed to the copy, the format or the topic.

People usually see our LinkedIn content and assume that's the engine behind ColdIQ. It's one of four layers that pull 55,000+ visits a month and support $7M ARR:

1. Marketing. LinkedIn does the heaviest lifting (~15,000 visits/mo, 20+ teammates posting). Then SEO run by Yevhen, paid run by Ivan, cold outreach run by Kenny, and the newsletter and webinars from Monika and Harry.

2. Lead capture. Midbound and Vector surface anonymous visitors, and everything routes through n8n to get scored by Clay, OpenAI and PredictLeads before a salesperson sees it.

3. Sales. 2 to 3 Google Meet calls, $5K to $10K/month retainers. Case studies, VSL and free content do the qualifying before discovery.

4. Delivery. n8n runs the kickoff, and GSuite, Supabase, Stripe and Slack are synced so admin happens without anyone in the loop. Our GTM engineers only touch the ICP matrix, campaign concepts and copy.

Which layer is the weakest in yours right now?

Editorial changes	• Cut it from about 430 words to about 155 by dropping most per-channel stats and tool lists while keeping the four-layer structure and the team members' names (the audit found 400+ word posts underperform this account's baseline). • Rewrote the 'Most people see... It's not.' opener, which is a banned contrast pattern in the ColdIQ SOP, as a plain first-person observation. • Replaced '(bookmark for later)' with a reply question. Bookmarks are already strong here and replies are the weak metric. • Fact flag: the original's channel figures (~15K + ~10K + ~6K + ~4K + ~11K) add up to about 46K, not 55,000+, and post 2105340823969878477 says 40,000 visitors a month. Confirm the current figure before publishing.
Test	Publish as the first post of the day. After 48h compare views/baseline against the original's 0.18x, bookmarks per 1k (original 22.2) and replies per 1k (original 0.4), to see whether the shorter version keeps the save rate.
Drafted by	claude-sonnet (session reviewer)

11. 30-day growth plan

> Sample sizes assume a two-sided test at alpha 0.05 and 80% power on log views, using the residual spread after month/format/topic controls. In 30 days at 12.0 authored posts/week (~26 per arm), only changes of about 2.3x or larger in median views are detectable; detecting 1.3x would need ~251 posts per arm (~42 weeks). Smaller effects show up as direction only: read 30-day results as signals to keep testing, not as proof.

Week	Experiment	Hypothesis · intervention · control	Primary metric	Decision rule	Power
1	**Freeze the baseline and fix data gaps**	Current medians are a valid benchmark for the next 3 weeks. *Do:* Start daily metric snapshots (monitoring) for posts and follower count; log every post's format and topic at publish time. *Compare:* n/a Secondary: metric snapshots per post at 24h/72h/7d · Confounders: none · Minimum period: 7 days	data completeness	Proceed when 24h/72h snapshots exist for every new post.	n/a
1	**Space authored posts (max 2/day, >= 6h apart)** diagnostic: supported, medium	Same-day stacking is associated with lower reach for later posts (author-diversity mechanism). *Do:* Cap authored posts at 2 per day, >= 6h apart; extra items become replies/threads or move to the next day. *Compare:* Previous 4 weeks of the same account (pre/post) and the stacking days in history Secondary: weekly total authored views, posts/week · Confounders: format mix, seasonality · Minimum period: 3-4 weeks	median views relative to trailing baseline	Keep spacing if median vs-baseline of posts that would have been 3rd+ rises above 0.8x without lowering weekly total views by > 10%.	105 posts/arm **underpowered in 30 days (~17.5 wks)** — read as directional
2	**Article-anchored week vs mixed week** diagnostic: supported, high	X Articles (with a native preview post) outperform other formats on matched topics. *Do:* Alternate weeks: anchor week = 2-3 X Articles on core topics + supporting posts; control week = usual mix. *Compare:* Alternating control weeks (A/B/A/B) Secondary: bookmarks per 1k views, replies per 1k views · Confounders: topic, promotion effort, co-founder reshares · Minimum period: 4 weeks (alternating)	median views per authored post	Adopt as default if anchor-week median >= 1.3x control-week median in both alternating pairs.	251 posts/arm **underpowered in 30 days (~41.9 wks)** — read as directional
2	**Outcome-first hooks vs current openers** diagnostic: mixed, low	Openings that state a concrete outcome or how-to promise earn more expands/dwell than observational openers. *Do:* Randomise (coin flip per post) between an outcome/how-to hook and the author's natural opener for non-article posts. *Compare:* Coin-flip control posts Secondary: likes per 1k, bookmarks per 1k · Confounders: topic, format · Minimum period: 3-4 weeks	median views vs baseline	Adopt if treatment median vs-baseline exceeds control by >= 1.3x with both arms >= 8 posts.	105 posts/arm **underpowered in 30 days (~17.5 wks)** — read as directional
2	**Specific closing prompt + first-hour author replies** diagnostic: supported, medium	Ending with a specific, answerable question and replying to early commenters raises replies per 1k views. *Do:* Half of posts (randomised) end with a specific question; author replies to the first 5 comments within 60 minutes. *Compare:* Randomised posts without the prompt Secondary: views vs baseline, share of posts with >= 5 replies · Confounders: topic, time of day · Minimum period: 4 weeks	replies per 1k views	Adopt if replies per 1k views is >= 1.3x control with no drop in views vs baseline.	105 posts/arm **underpowered in 30 days (~17.5 wks)** — read as directional
3	**Expert-addition comments on larger in-niche accounts** diagnostic: supported, medium	2-3 sentence expert additions on in-niche posts earn more views and reply-backs than generic replies. *Do:* 10 comments/day: substantive additions on posts < 60 min old from accounts with 2-20x the client's followers in core topics; stop emoji/one-word replies. *Compare:* The account's previous 4 weeks of conversational comments Secondary: share of comments that receive a reply, new accounts engaging with the client's posts · Confounders: parent-post reach, parent author · Minimum period: 2-3 weeks	median views per comment	Continue if median views per comment >= 2x the previous median and reply-back share rises.	n/a
3	**Lead-magnet delivery without mass identical**	Delivering lead magnets via DM/pinned reply instead of hundreds of identical public 'Sent' replies keeps conversions and	keyword comments per lead-magnet post	Switch if comments per post are within 15% of control.	n/a

	replies diagnostic: supported, low	removes a duplicate-reply risk. *Do:* For half of lead-magnet posts (alternating), deliver via one pinned reply + DM automation; vary wording. *Compare:* Alternating lead-magnet posts with the current 'Sent' replies Secondary: views vs baseline of the lead-magnet post, DMs delivered · Confounders: lead-magnet topic, CTA wording · Minimum period: 4 weeks (needs >= 4 lead-magnet posts per arm)			
4	**Evaluate, keep or drop**	n/a *Do:* Re-run the full audit pipeline; compare each experiment's primary metric against its decision rule. *Compare:* n/a Secondary: · Confounders: seasonality · Minimum period: end of week 4	decision per experiment	Retain experiments that met their rule; extend underpowered ones rather than calling them.	n/a

12. The fourteen questions

1. Why is the account receiving its current level of reach?

Median authored post: 5274 views (n=301). Ranked potential drivers: 1. Content format drives most of the reach difference (high); 2. Reach trend over the window (medium); 3. Low conversation generation per impression (medium); 4. Commenting is low-depth and concentrated on a small circle (medium); 5. Several authored posts on the same day (medium) statistical association

2. Which content types perform best and worst?

Best: narrative=promotion 2.68x (n=18); format=x_article 1.91x (n=105); topic=LinkedIn & social selling 1.40x (n=46); narrative=tutorial 1.36x (n=113). Worst: format=short_post 0.18x (n=10); format=long_post 0.53x (n=45). statistical association

3. Which posting behaviours are associated with better results?

length_bucket=very long (400+) 0.46x (n=37); length_bucket=very short (<15 words) 1.95x (n=130); has_list=False 1.67x (n=220); has_list=True 0.60x (n=81). Same-day order (median vs baseline): 1st 0.94x (n=141), 2nd 0.99x (n=103), 3rd+ 0.60x (n=52) statistical association

4. Is the commenting strategy effective?

88 conversational comments in the window; 33% are substantive and 39% are generic, repetitive or humour. The top 5 accounts receive 49% of comments; median exposure is 58.5 views per comment. account observed

5. Which interactions are producing meaningful audience exposure?

Top comment targets by views: account observed

6. Are there observable signs of potential visibility limitations?

0 of 301 mature authored posts have fewer than 100 views; reach is continuous with the account's normal range. No public signal indicates a visibility restriction; this audit cannot observe X's visibility-filtering decisions. insufficient

7. What does the published X algorithm actually tell us?

Ranking is a weighted sum of per-viewer predicted action probabilities (reply 5.0, like 0.66, share-via-copy-link 20.0, follow 4.0, profile click 0.0, report -234.0 in published defaults), with author-diversity decay within a feed, a 0.75 out-of-network factor, a 48-hour age cutoff and candidate retrieval driven by viewers' engagement history. See the findings registry. repo verified

8. Which common algorithm claims are unsupported?

TweepCred below 65 limits an account to 3 tweets being considered (not found in repo); Posts with external links get a 30-50% reach penalty (not found in repo); Using 3 or more hashtags gets a post penalised (not found in repo); Premium/verified accounts get a 4x in-network and 2x out-of-network boost (not found in repo); One report cancels out 468 likes (contradicted); Replies are worth 27x a like (contradicted); A reply the author engages with is worth 75x (or 150x) a like (not found in repo); Bookmarks are worth 20x a like (not found in repo); A good click / dwell (2+ minutes) is worth 10-11x a like (contradicted); Scores decay with a 6-hour half-life (contradicted) unsupported

9. How does the account compare with relevant peers?

authored per week: 12.11 vs peer median 7.58; views per 1k followers: 306.72 vs peer median 220.70; eng per 1k views: 16.47 vs peer median 16.70; replies per 1k: 0.98 vs peer median 1.81; bookmarks per 1k: 8.76 vs peer median 2.76 statistical association

10. What should the account stop doing?

Reduce: Content format: short_post (0.18x median, n=10); Reduce: Content format: long_post (0.53x median, n=45); Stop publishing a 3rd authored post on the same day; Stop generic/emoji-only comments; they earn little exposure; Stop mass identical public 'Sent' replies (test DM/pinned delivery) statistical association

11. What should the account continue doing?

Keep: Content format: x_article (1.91x median, n=105); Keep: Narrative structure: promotion (4.67x median, n=17) (excluding X Articles); Keep: Educational value (0-3): 1.0 (2.62x median, n=31) (excluding X Articles) statistical association

12. What should the account start doing?

Start measuring: daily metric snapshots + follower history (monitoring); Start the randomised hook and closing-prompt tests (see 30-day plan); Start substantive comments on larger in-niche accounts within their first hour; Start replying to early commenters within 60 minutes to build conversation depth hypothesis

13. Which changes should be tested first?

Week 1: Freeze the baseline and fix data gaps; Week 1: Space authored posts (max 2/day, >= 6h apart); Week 2: Article-anchored week vs mixed week; Week 2: Outcome-first hooks vs current openers; Week 2: Specific closing prompt + first-hour author replies hypothesis

14. How will we measure whether those changes work?

Each experiment has a primary metric and decision rule (see 30-day plan); judged on medians of views vs trailing baseline, replies/bookmarks per 1k views. Sample sizes assume a two-sided test at alpha 0.05 and 80% power on log views, using the residual spread after month/format/topic controls. In 30 days at 12.0 authored posts/week (~26 per arm), only changes of about 2.3x or larger in median views are detectable; detecting 1.3x would need ~251 posts per arm (~42 weeks). Smaller effects show up as direction only: read 30-day results as signals to keep testing, not as proof. hypothesis

Appendix — common algorithm claims checked against the repository

Claim	Verdict	Explanation
X uses a TweepCred-style reputation score for accounts	partially supported	There is no "TweepCred" in this repo, but user-cred-v2 computes a PageRank-based per-account score (0-100) from follow edges, with premium accounts and like/repost engagement in the teleport set. In this code the score is consumed by spam/abuse systems as an exemption threshold, not by the For You value model. user-cred-v2/UserCredV2.scala:9-20 botmaker-rules/scarecrow/derived-feature/IsHighPageRankUser.df:1-28 xai-value-model/inputs.rs:3-17
TweepCred below 65 limits an account to 3 tweets being considered	not found in repo	No TweepCred, no threshold of 65, and no per-author cap of 3 tweets were found in the published ranking code. The user-cred thresholds visible here are 54 (scarecrow high-PageRank), 50.0 (abuse-enforcement skip) and 66 (Grox reply-label exemption), and they gate spam labelling, not tweet counts. Absence here does not prove absence in production. abuse-enforcement-service/service-lib/rules/enforcement_user.yaml:32-38 grox/flows/reply_spam/constants.py:9-9
Posts with external links get a 30-50% reach penalty	not found in repo	The published weighted score has no link-penalty term; open_link is a positive head (weight 0.2). A has_url content feature exists only in an experimental debias payload that is off by default and is not read by the published value model. Link-specific effects could still arise from model predictions or URL-quality spam rules, which this does not rule out. home-mixer/params/param.rs:373-373 home-mixer/params/param.rs:502-507 home-mixer/models/content_features.rs:8-20
Using 3 or more hashtags gets a post penalised	not found in repo	No hashtag count or hashtag penalty appears in home-mixer, vm-ranker or xai-value-model; hashtags appear only in SimClusters entity extraction, muted keyword handling, ads tests and Agatha data loaders. This is absent from the public ranking code, not proven absent in production.
Premium/verified accounts get a 4x in-network and 2x out-of-network boost	not found in repo	No verification or premium multiplier appears in the For You scoring code; the only post-fusion multipliers are author diversity and the out-of-network factor. Premium status does appear in user-cred-v2 as the uniform teleport set, and gray/grey-badge status exempts accounts from some spam labels, which are indirect effects, not a ranking boost. xai-value-model/scoring.rs:12-26 user-cred-v2/UserCredV2App.scala:173-175
One report cancels out 468 likes	contradicted	The ratio comes from ReportWeight -234 vs a favorite weight of 0.5, but the weights multiply each viewer's predicted probabilities, not raw counts, and the code comment explicitly calls this reading incorrect. The current home-mixer favorite default is 0.66, so even the ratio differs by file. home-mixer/params/param.rs:320-330 home-mixer/params/param.rs:457-457
Replies are worth 27x a like	contradicted	Current defaults are ReplyWeight 5.0 and FavoriteWeight 0.66 in home-mixer (0.5 in vm-ranker), i.e. roughly 7.6x-10x, and they weight predicted probabilities rather than counts. The 27x figure may describe the 2023 heavy ranker, which is not in this repo. home-mixer/params/param.rs:345-346 vm-ranker/params.rs:3-4
A reply the author engages with is worth 75x (or 150x) a like	not found in repo	The current Phoenix heads have no "reply engaged by author" prediction; the weighted score sums the listed heads only. These numbers come from the 2023 heavy-ranker configuration, which is not part of this repository. xai-value-model/phoenix_scores.rs:1-31
Bookmarks are worth 20x a like	not found in repo	There is no bookmark prediction head or bookmark weight in the scoring code; bookmarks appear as viewer engagement-history signals and candidate counts. A weight of 20.0 exists for share_via_copy_link, which is a different action. xai-value-model/phoenix_scores.rs:1-31 home-mixer/params/param.rs:388-393 home-mixer/models/engagement_signals.rs:20-26
A good click / dwell (2+ minutes) is worth 10-11x a like	contradicted	Current defaults are ClickWeight 0.3, DwellWeight 0.05, ContDwellTimeWeight 0.006 and ContClickDwellTimeWeight 0.4 (per unit of predicted dwell time); there is no "good click" head with weight 10-11. The figure appears to come from the 2023 heavy ranker, not this code. home-mixer/params/param.rs:372-372 home-mixer/params/param.rs:432-437
Scores decay with a 6-hour half-life	contradicted	The published weighted score has no time-decay term; freshness is enforced by a hard 48-hour age cutoff. The only half-life found in home-mixer is 8 hours, used to normalise views in the popular-posts retrieval source, not to decay ranking scores. Recency could still be learned implicitly by the prediction model. xai-value-model/scoring.rs:69-140 home-mixer/params/config.rs:40-40 home-mixer/util/popular_posts.rs:36-46
The first 30 minutes decide a post's distribution	not found in repo	No 30-minute decision window exists in the ranking code. Related time windows are the cold-start lift for posts under 7,200 s old with fewer than 200 home impressions, a 0.5-hour age floor in popular-posts view normalisation, and the 48-hour age cutoff. Absence here is not proof of absence in production. home-mixer/params/param.rs:562-567 home-mixer/util/popular_posts.rs:36-46

An Author Diversity Scorer throttles accounts that post frequently	partially supported	An author-diversity multiplier exists, but it applies within a single viewer's candidate set: the k-th additional post from the same author is multiplied by 0.75 * 0.5^k + 0.25. It does not count how often an account posts overall. xai-value-model/scoring.rs:183-204 vm-ranker/params.rs:175-186
Grok reads every post and down-ranks negative sentiment	not found in repo	Grox runs LLM/VLM classifiers for safety, spam, reply spam and a "banger" screen, but no sentiment score or sentiment term appears in the ranking formula, and Grox flows are gated (e.g. multimodal embedding uses an adaptive minimum like count starting at 20,000). Prompts are withheld, so the exact criteria cannot be checked. grox/flows/ptos/prompts.py:11-11 grox/flows/mm_emb/adaptive_min_fav.py:6-19
Spelling errors cause a deboost	not found in repo	No spelling or typo check appears in the ranking or filtering code. Repo-wide regex matches are unrelated substrings (e.g. "tyPo" inside identifiers in a Grox file, a CLI-parsing test name in Phoenix). Not proof of absence in production; Grox prompts are withheld.
Mass unfollowing triggers a 3-month shadowban	not found in repo	No unfollow-based penalty or 3-month restriction appears in home-mixer, visibility-filtering or the published enforcement rules. bdsm's FollowBot head targets automated follow behaviour, but its thresholds are redacted and no duration like 3 months is published. bdsm/runtime/sink_policy.yaml:15-20
SimClusters has about 145k communities	partially supported	The SimClusters code refers to a model version named Model20M145K2020, which is consistent with ~145K clusters, but no explicit cluster count constant was found. SimClusters is used in home-mixer as one retrieval source. simclusters/simclusters_v2/summingbird/common/SimClustersProfile.scala:145-145
Video posts get 10x reach	not found in repo	No video multiplier exists in the scoring code. Video heads carry small weights by default (video_open 0.02 in home-mixer, video quality view 0.0). Video can still affect predicted engagement and has dedicated carousel and immersive surfaces, so effects on reach are not ruled out. home-mixer/params/param.rs:366-371 home-mixer/params/param.rs:380-380
Replies between mutual followers get boosted	partially supported	A bidirectional-follow boost exists (default +15 on the reply weight), but it applies to original posts from authors the viewer mutually follows, raising the weight on the predicted probability that the viewer replies. Replies and reposts are explicitly excluded from eligibility. xai-value-model/inputs.rs:19-23 home-mixer/params/param.rs:347-352 docs/BIDIRECTIONAL_BOOST_CHANGE.md:5-5
Profile clicks are a major ranking signal	contradicted	ProfileClickWeight defaults to 0.0 and profile-visit seconds are weighted 0.0 (home-mixer hard-codes it to 0.0), so predicted profile clicks do not add to the published weighted score at defaults. Experiments could set non-zero values. home-mixer/params/param.rs:374-379 home-mixer/scorers/value_model.rs:38-40
Out-of-network posts are down-weighted	supported	Out-of-network candidates (and, by default, in-network replies and reposts) are multiplied by effective_oon_weight, which defaults to OonWeightFactor 0.75 (0.5 for topic requests). Out-of-network posts also face extra visibility drop rules. xai-value-model/scoring.rs:206-215 vm-ranker/params.rs:211-216
Posting too often cannibalises your own reach	partially supported	Within one viewer's feed, repeated posts by the same author are discounted (author diversity) and only one post per conversation is kept, so several simultaneous posts compete with each other for that viewer. Nothing in the code penalises posting frequency globally or across viewers. xai-value-model/scoring.rs:183-185 home-mixer/filters/dedup_conversation_filter.rs:19-36
Mass blocking/reporting by bad actors suppresses an account's reach	unverifiable	For ranking, the code comment states that weights apply to each viewer's predicted probabilities and that only actions on posts served in Home Timeline count, so coordinated reports mainly affect similar users. However, Agatha computes account-level blocks-per-fav and reports-per-fav rates that feed account models, and the thresholds turning those into labels are not published. home-mixer/params/param.rs:332-344 agatha/scalding/labels/rate_based_labels/RateBasedLabels.scala:80-90